minjokherald

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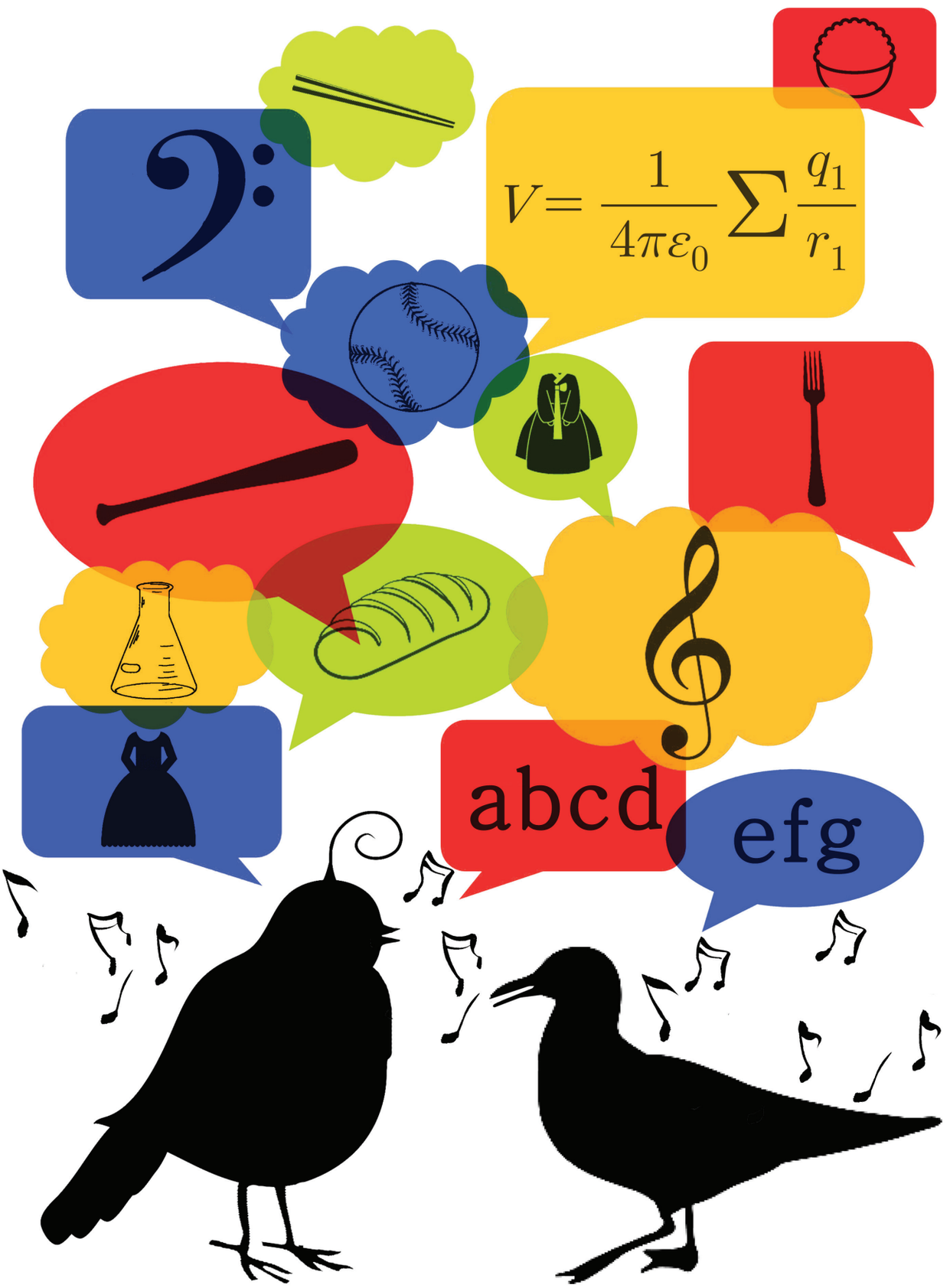
Editor's Note

I have spent a ridiculous amount of time wondering what to write in my first editor's note, all the while thinking that the most difficult part of being an editor-in-chief is coming up with a decent thing to say. However, after weeks of wracking my mind and heart, I have decided to share two memorable comments I've received. One was, so eloquently said by one of my dear friends, "Revolutionize. Make some fundamental change. Don't just be any editor-in-chief. Be *the* editor-in-chief everyone will remember." The other was, not so much eloquent as frank, "Relax. It's not like anyone's going to read the whole thing anyway."

These two somewhat contrasting but nevertheless valuable remarks helped shape my, and the rest of the staff's, views and hopes for *Minjok Herald*. The urge to be different was our profoundest equipment in devising an initial plan for this edition. However, if the first statement told us to revolutionize, the second statement told us in which direction to do so. Upon hearing the latter statement (spoken to me by a friend) I, like all my fellow editors and crew members, could only hope that she was wrong. Happy as I am to present to you the newest edition of *Minjok Herald*, I, along with the rest of the staff, feel the need to take this allotted space to emphasize that *Minjok Herald* belongs to the readers, to you. *Minjok Herald* is not a stage for reporters to show off in a hey-look-at-my-awe-some-English-writing-skills attitude, nor is it a stage for me to scream, "Look everyone! Look at how good I am at my job!" No. It is your channel of communication. It allows us to get to know ourselves little better. It brings us a step closer together.

Our devoted staff members run around school campus unveiling truths, seeking and revealing new aspects in the people around us. We question the status quo to instigate healthy discussions and voice our viewpoints on KMLAian society. We strive sincerely to convey your message. Now, it's your turn. Read the *Minjok Herald*, and don't just stop at that. Tell us what you think after reading an article. Challenge our editorials. Give suggestions on how to design, what issues to cover, and who to interview. Feel free to criticize our writers and myself. Interact with us to get your message conveyed.

With your assistance and devotion, *Minjok Herald* will continue to change. Change in a direction in which the copy of *Minjok Herald* you are holding right now will make its inevitable journey to the wastebasket only after have been given a thorough read.

Read. Enjoy. Interact. For your readership, enjoyment, and interaction is what we truly yearn for.

Respectfully,
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Lee Eun-Ji

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BY THE STUDENTS and
FOR THE STUDENTS

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As Student Opinion Varies on New H+IR Module, School Reassures Doubts

At the start of the semester, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) implemented a new curricular system planned out by Office of Curriculum Management. In this new curricular system, the H-Module courses and Individual Research (IR) courses have been combined into one module called the H+IR Module. With the advent of the H+IR Module System, students can now fill four to eight hours of their weekly classes with a broader range of courses from both the H-Module and IR.

Mr. Park Yong-Sung, the current manager of the Office of Curriculum Management originally hoped for an education system in which students would complete their required units of classes in the morning and use their afternoons as time for Individual Research. Although Mr. Park states that such a system is not possible today, the new curricular change can be seen as his first step to an ideal curriculum.

However, opinions on this new system seem to differ from person to person. Starting from the 17th of September, an online questionnaire regarding the H+IR Module System has been launched to hear the thoughts of KMLA students on this educational policy. Students from all three waves participated. According to this survey, 56% responded that the new system was better and 26% answered that the system was worse. The remaining 18% replied that the new system didn't bring influential change.

Students who favored the new system praised it for its more flexible timetables, broader range of classes, and convenient registration process. An anonymous student says, "At first, I was astonished by the number of classes opened for me to choose. Also, since same classes are open in different modules, I could plan out my timetable more easily than last semester." However, those who criticized the system complained about the limitation of students for courses, the lack of time for community services, and the clashing of their favorable classes in the same periods. A good example of this is the incident that occurred in the volunteer organization Stop-Hunger. The volunteer organization originally had the service planned on Tuesday 7th and 8th period. Unfortunately, a popular class AP Microeconomics was opened for 17th wavers at that time as well. As a result, the organization had a very hard time to cover up the people that they lacked.

Nevertheless, in a recent interview with Mr. Park, he states that many improvements have been made to the new curricular system. First, he says, the chances of classes clashing have been reduced significantly through pre-registration periods and cooperation between teachers. Second, the number of required units in the H+IR Module has been reduced from 8 units to 4 units, giving students more time for community service. And last but not least, he says that there are no student limits for any courses except foreign language courses for freshman.

Mr. Park has stated firmly in his interview that the new H+IR Module system will continue on and believes that enhancements can be made through time. The new curricular system can be a stepping-stone for accomplishing Mr. Park's idea of providing students with a diversity of courses in the hopes that each student will get the ideal education that they have always longed for. As with all new things, this curricular change will receive criticisms as it keeps on developing into a system that all students will consider ideal one day.

As with all new things, this curricular change will receive criticisms as it keeps developing into a system that all students will consider ideal one day.

Kim Byeong-Yun
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

New and Interesting Classes Present Wide Opportunities for KMLA Students

A new semester has begun, and students in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) have noticed several changes: new teachers on campus, a new registration system, and new names on the course list. These unfamiliar or interesting names that have appeared on the list were a big source of curiosity for many KMLA students. Thus, Minjok Herald looked into the courses Mechatronics, Positive Psychology, Big History, Social Psychology, and Baduk (Korean Checkers) in an attempt to satiate this curiosity.

Mechatronics is, according to Wikitionary: 'the synergistic combination of mechanical engineering, electronic engineering and software engineering for the study of automata from an engineering perspective and the control of advanced hybrid systems.' This new and somewhat unfamiliar (especially to those in the humanities field) class is being taught by Mr. Park Hong-Jae and is conducted by presentations and discussions. For Mechatronics I, Mr. Park gives an overview of the subject for four weeks, and then lets the students choose and present certain topics on the subject. For Mechatronics II, students deal with a deeper study, such as mainboard construction and ASM/C software development.

Big History is, according to Mr. Kim Jung-Mu who teaches the class, a combination of natural history and human history, thereby creating a new big history. It deals with history starting from the big bang all the way to the present. The focus of the class is to recognize the interrelation between nature and humans throughout history; how they had affected and are affecting one another. This idea has been recently suggested by David Christian, an American historian, and Bill Gates has sponsored this idea in order to let every American high schools teach this as a subject. This eventually led to the subject's introduction in Korea, and this is the first time it has been available for KMLA students. Next year, Mr. Kim mentioned that he plans to teach with Mr. Ganse in the same classroom, lecturing right after one-another to provide a deeper understanding of the subject.

Many students have been curious not only about Mechatronics or Big History but also about the new Psychology teacher Ms. Kim Yeo-Ram and her several psychology courses that sounded interesting. One of them is Social Psychology, a class that gives basic understanding of what is currently happening in the field of Social Psychology. It is done by pre-reading short theses, discussing them in class, and often watching related videos. However, Ms. Kim mentioned that since it is her first time teaching such subject, the class may change a lot both in content and style next semester. Another one is Positive Psychology, also taught by Ms. Kim. As its name suggests, this is a branch of psychology that studies the positive side of human life. Positive Psychologists focus on positive aspects, such as happiness, according to Ms. Kim, and the lecture is comprised mostly of her presentations. She uses the book Positive Psychology by Baumgardner, S.R. & Crothers, M.K. as the textbook of the class. This class also leaves the possibility of a big change, Ms. Kim added.

Other than Psychology, many students have been captured by another interesting course: Baduk. Baduk, in other words Korean Checkers, is being taught by Mr. Hinde. The class is held every Thursday afternoon, and Mr. Hinde says that this is a very interesting class. His class is comprised of both complete beginners and experienced students, including the former city champion. Usually, Mr. Hinde and the students all talk about the fundamental tactics, practice, and discuss again about what they just did. He said that he does not do anything more than any of the 26 or 27 students in his class.

There are not only the ones mentioned above but many other new or interesting subjects in

KMLA, such as Cell Biology, Latin IR, and Children's Story-making Class. Students in KMLA are free to go to teachers and ask them for new courses if they want to. Being able to take and open classes they want, KMLA students obviously have wonderful opportunities!

Kim Sol
Staff Writer, 16th Wave

Elections this Semester Lack Candidates and Encounter Invalid Candidates

Many Feel the Need for More Passion among Students

Every new semester of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) starts off with elections for the new Student Council. Candidates make inspiring speeches, conduct campaigns, and debate each other. However, this semester, an important thing was lacking: the candidates.

Only two students ran for the Judicial Branch this semester. The Judicial Branch is comprised of one chief and two vice chiefs, meaning that this semester's election lacked even the minimum number of candidates required to form a complete Judicial Branch. Neither was there any 10th grade male student running for the member of the Legislative Branch. Thus, additional elections had to be held afterwards in order to fill the quota of the branches.

However, the special election was relatively less thorough compared to the main election in many aspects. There was no debate between the candidates, no questions from the previous student council, and no campaigns. All of these components were replaced by a brief campaign speech and a few questions asked by students. Also, the number of hits on the candidates' written assignments on KMLA online was lower in the special election, with an average of 257 compared to the average of 409 in the main election.

Elections are the process of deciding the leaders of the autonomous student body and can be seen as a process of shaping KMLA's future. In this sense, the lack of candidates this semester was seen as unfortunate by students and teachers alike. The number of candidates has been diminishing since the 12th Student Council election. A total of 23 candidates ran for the election for the 12th student council. The number decreased to 20 for the 13th and decreased again to 17 for the 14th this semester.

Poster for Kim Zion during the election campaign

Another key trait of this semester's election was the occurrence of a few invalid candidates. Only a few days after the election, many male students were confused during honjeong as Lee Eun-Do, the former Chief of the Executive Branch elected on September 7th (the main election), sat beside his roommates, and Kim Zion, one of the elected Vice Chief of the Executive Branch, started to lead honjeong without a clear explanation. As it turned out, the school had discovered that the penalty points Lee received during his first year exceeded the qualification line to run for the election in the first place.

Eventually, after a period of temporary suspension of performing the Chief 's duties, Lee resigned from his standing to prevent further controversy. The incident was attributed to the 13th Executive Branch. The 13th Executive Branch had managed the elections for the 14th Executive Branch, so they had the obligation to thoroughly examine whether each of the candidates met the qualifications. Although the 13th Executive Branch publically apologized through KMLA online, many students criticized them, saying that the resignation of an elected chief representative is too significant to let pass with a simple apology.

This was not the only invalid candidates that occurred. In the special elections that were held afterwards, two other candidates running for the Vice Chief of the Judicial Branch resigned after the school examined their penalty points. Again, this was after the 13th Judicial Branch had already examined them and qualified them as apt candidates.

Although the election this semester might not have been the best one, the 14th Student Council is now complete, ready to improve KMLA with its bright vision and new policies. Now, the consensus is that KMLAians view and judge the new student council with objectivity, regardless of some of the flaws that had taken place during the election.

Lee Chang-Hun
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

Three Generation Athletics Meeting Remodeled with Stricter Rules and More Games

Changes seen as Successful Overall

On September 15th, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) held the Three Generation Athletics Meeting at the school campus. This is a school athletic competition in which the students' parents and grandparents are invited. Although the athletics meeting is both an annual event and a tradition of KMLA that has been done for many years, this year's meeting showed a substantial diversion from those of the past years. Instead of the conventional formation and sporting events which put emphasis on 'health and physical fitness,' this time the school administration turned its attention to 'entertainment.' Several major changes involve the rules and the sporting events.

17th wave Students Dance to Aint Nothing Wrong with That in the three generation athletics meeting

Due to some inconveniences of the old rules, the administration presented new rules, which every students were obliged to follow. Students were not allowed to move around freely during the meeting, except during lunch time. A rectangular rope fence marked the boundary between students and the rest of the families. It was expected that the students stay in the fence, while the families do not enter the fence. Furthermore, students were prohibited even from moving around in the fence when any event was in progress. These rules fostered the smooth progression of events, thus lightening the burden of many teachers and parent representatives. However, despite such strict regulations, many students sporadically broke away from the crowd, most of them claiming to go to the restrooms located in Chugmoo and Dasan Hall. Moreover, a large number of students voiced their discontent over the new rule, stating that it was hard for the students to truly enjoy the event when they were continuously leashed to regulations.

The sporting events also went under several changes. First, two new events were created; cooperative ball bouncing and cheering. Both events were received favorably by the students and the families. The cheering tournament especially caused quite a sensation among the guests, with 10th graders wearing pink hoodies and colorful gloves and 11th graders dancing a remake of PSY's 'Gangnam Style,' 'Minsa Style.' Second, existing games were also slightly altered so that the audience could enjoy and laugh. For instance, the relay race was changed into a relay obstacle course. In this game, the participants were given missions such as spinning around, wearing baggy pants, crawling through a net, and finding candies in a dish of flour. This seemed to be a good move since everyone, even the participants who were at first reluctant to be ashamed in front of the crowd, later became quite satisfied at the relay.

Although the reactions to the changes were not all-positive, the alterations seem to have made the annual event a more dynamic and enjoyable one overall.

Lee Hye-Joon
Staff Writer, 16th Wave

All About Global Leadership Program for Students

Perspectives of Participants, Students, and Teachers

GLPS students immersed in studying

Many colleges have camps for aspirants, be it RISE and SIMR for Stanford, or the secondary school program for Harvard. Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA)'s equivalent is the Global Leadership Program for Students (GLPS). GLPS is a camp that is held during summer and winter vacations, the latest one being the eighteenth. The camp lasts four weeks and approximately 400 fifth to eighth graders participate in it biannually. Participants live in the dormitory building, take classes in the Dasan, Chungmoo Halls and the Minjok Cultural Center, have self-study periods and keep English Only Policy (EOP), just like the students in KMLA. The classes that the participants attend are quite diverse and include English, debate, history, literature, mathematics, and physical education. By attending this camp, participants can experience what the environment at KMLA is like and gain the ability to study independently.

Mr. Wayne Baumgardner talks with a crowd of GLPS students

KMLA students and graduates participate in GLPS as Program Assistant (PA)'s or Teacher Assistant (TA)'s. PA's are assigned to one of the classes that participants are placed in at the beginning of the camp while TA's teach additional classes for the participants. In addition, each PA or TA also works as a room PA for one or two of the rooms in the dormitory. Room PA's have to look after the participants who live in the rooms that they are assigned and have *honjeongs* with them. For their work, half-camp PA's and TA's who work at GLPS for two weeks are awarded with a scholarship of five hundred thousand won while full-camp PA's and TA's are paid one million and one hundred thousand won. Lee Seo-Yun, a 17th waver, stated that a PA aids the advisors, leads the students around campus, inform them, write comments about them every week , and check their English diaries.

Meanwhile, there are currently three kinds of TA's in GLPS: Debate, Writing, and History. Joo Hannah was a debate TA, and her job was to teach debate to 5th and 6th graders. She said that although teaching at GLPS wasn't as organized or liberal as she thought, teaching debate was very helpful for her own debating skills, and also that she appreciated the company of the participants. Park So-Hyeon was a writing TA and had to proofread the essays of the participants and write comments to improve their writing. She stated, "GLPS is, in essence, a job and requires a lot of responsibility." Chang Yoon-Hoo, as a history TA, helped one of the history teachers with procedures like sending e-mails regarding the participants' scores and gathering necessary reference material. She said that working as a TA helps one become more responsible, lets one truly appreciate what one's parents have done for them and lets one enjoy KMLA to its fullest. Finally, Park Hyung-Jun, a KMLA graduate who has participated in GLPS twice (once as a biology TA, a post which no longer exists, and once as a debate TA), said that staying in school and getting to know teachers, fellow students and GLPS participants was one of the greatest merits, as it lets one learn about social relationships. However, he also stated that these merits could be counterproductive if it hinders the actual work that is to be done as a TA or PA. He believes that a system that removes problematic PAs or TAs should exist so that everyone can enjoy the benefits of GLPS. All in all, everyone recommended working at GLPS but that the burden of responsibility is not to be underestimated.

Although many teachers at GLPS are not from KMLA, some of the teachers at KMLA can also choose to take part. Mr. Ganse, who teaches history, said GLPS provides teachers with an "opportunity to practice education without anybody telling you how to teach", or in other words, a "chance to do experimental teaching." as the interference of the school administration is considerably less than that during the semesters. Mrs. Son, who teaches history during the school term and worked as a counselor during the last three GLPS terms, also provided some insight into the GLPS. Through her experience, she realized that participants undergo a lot of stress mainly because of the large workload of GLPS, especially since four weeks is quite long. Due to this stress, many participants are hurt when teachers, PA's or TA's act callously. Finally, she said that she was grateful for this opportunity to listen to the participants' interests and thoughts.

Choosing to spend four weeks, or even two weeks to take part in GLPS will not be easy and will require deft prioritization as it is a major portion of the vacation period. Nonetheless, it may be valuable to make the time to participate in an activity that fosters one's responsibility and rewards one's work with a worthy salary. The choice is entirely up to the students and teachers.

Lee Jin-Gyu
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

Many Student Clubs Created at the Start of the New Semester

A Glimpse into KARE, Wikipedia KMLA, Icon, and TEDxMinjok

The club activity is one of the important factors which represent the trait of KMLA. There are about 80 clubs that can be classified into the performance, the academic, the athletic, research, voluntary service, the press, and so on. Most importantly, the club activity is a channel for students to relieve all the stress from schoolwork. Furthermore, the students are able to develop their special abilities, pursue their interests and promote friendship among club members through club activities.

As the numbers show, there are so many clubs, so that the students are able to pursue any activities that they're eager to do. However, despite the variety of choices that existing clubs offer, about 10~20 clubs are constantly set up biannually. In spite of each clubs' unique purpose and characteristic, Minjok Herald took a glimpse at some of the new clubs created: *KARE, Wikipedia KMLA, Icon, and TEDxMinjok.*

KARE

KARE is an abbreviation of Kmla Coexistence of Animal Rights on Earth. It is a volunteer club to promote and practice the protection of animal rights. The club is planning to volunteer for the abandoned dogs' shelter or conduct a fundraising program to encourage abandoned dogs in need. The club was formed by 16th waver Min Ji-Seon, who constantly had interests in animals. She gained the motivation of the animal protection club from CARE (Coexistence of Animal Rights on Earth) which she participated in during the summer vacation. Through the club activity, the chief hopes to motivate people to deal with animal rights problem more seriously.

Wikipedia KMLA

Wikipedia KMLA is the club which edits existing documents and translates the foreign documents into Korean in order to increase the amount of information quantity in Korea Wikipedia. The chief Lee Yong-kyun of the 17th wavers found the club after experiencing due to the inconvenience of research with Korean Wikipedia. He felt dejected, after finding out the lack of information in Korea Wikipedia compared to other countries' website. Even though the club had difficulty in figuring out the motivation and the purpose at first, the chief realized that this activity benefits not only KMLA students but also the society as a whole. Planning out a cooperative and complex process to edit the documents, the chief hopes KMLA students to participate actively and passionately.

Icon

Icon is a debate club which deals with economic theories. The chief Kim Na-yeon of the 17th waver created the club to answer the fundamental economic questions through debates, since students are not able to wholly grasp the basic economic theories through the lectures. Though there were several conflicts about the course of club activity between club members at first, the club is finally on track. Kim hopes to have more conversation with other people, not only students, but also with teachers and professionals, about economic theories through the club activity.

Members of TedxMinjok

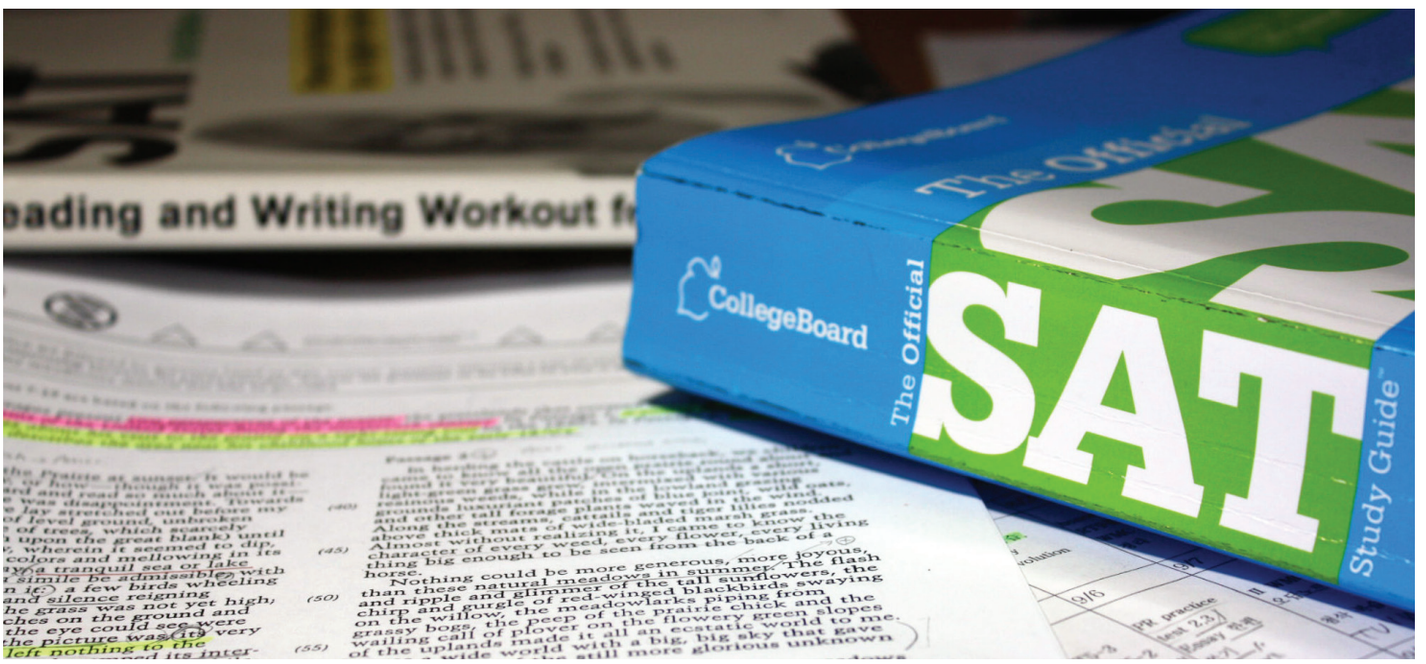
TEDxMinjok

TEDxMinjok is consisted of members who are interested in getting to know various majors and ideas. Members get together to spare their ideas worth spreading through short lectures. The chief Min Pu-reum of 17th waver was inspired from the TED which is a global set conference that hosts the lectures of prominent figures. At first, she about the number of members due to the limitation of time for lectures during the club activity. The chief hesitated whether to select few members to have long lectures like real TED or choose more members to add variety in lectures. She settled with having about twenty members. According to the chief, as students prepare lectures related with their major, the quality of lectures was better than she expected. Min hopes members to keep up the good work.

The club activity is one of the essential parts in KMLA life. The increase in number of clubs leads students to have more varied club activities. However, looking back, many clubs don't keep up the passion they originally had and soon disappear. Those problems are mainly caused by the irresponsibility of club members and their thinking of clubs as just one line in their college application. Thus, new club members need to keep up the passion they originally had, and have more responsibility in the activities to sustain their clubs continually.

Kim Ri-Hyun
Junior Writer,17th Wave

Preparing for SATs, Students Want School Assistance



Whenever Mrs. Lee Sun-Jin counsels students in the international field, one factor that is always suggested as important is the students' SAT score. Students in the international field of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) usually study for and take the SAT I until they reach a score higher than 2250 (preferably higher than 2300). Although there are several courses on SATII subject tests, currently the school curriculum offers none but one preparatory course for SAT I – Mr. Woo Chang-Hyo's English Reading course. However, this class clashes with the popular American Literature and British Literature class in the same module, meaning that most KMLA students need to prepare for these exams on their own or through hagwons.

Many international field students in KMLA start studying for SAT I during the summer vacation of their sophomore year. When students return to the school after four weeks of intensive studying, however, the rigorous schedule of regular courses leaves little time for further SAT preparation. An anonymous 16th wave student who took SATI this October remarks, "If a SAT preparatory course was a part of the regular course, it would be great. Students would be able to study SAT continuously, with no fear of not being able to study regular courses." Nevertheless, considering that not all students start or finish the SATs at the same time, this suggestion seems quite unattainable.

An alternative solution suggested by students is to open an optional preparatory course during self-study period, or some other time not included in regular class hours. Students who are afraid that they would defer studying SAT without a supervisor can enroll in this extra class. If students feel that they are able to manage their times by themselves or that they do not want to lose their self-study period time for extra class, they can decide not to sign up. This is a system that several special purpose high schools have already implemented - Hanyoung Foreign Language School and Gyeonggi Foreign Language School, for instance. Another anonymous 16th waver expressed his positive opinion to this suggestion; "I am not very good at planning my time, so if the school opens an optional preparatory class, I would be able to receive help from teachers or peers and be able to continuously concentrate on studying SAT."

To this, Mr. Woo Chang-Hyo had his doubts about the effectiveness of an optional preparatory course but he expressed his openness to student wishes. "No one has come and asked me to open an SATI preparation course during IR time or self-study time. But if the demand for opening this course is high, I am willing to consider teaching it."

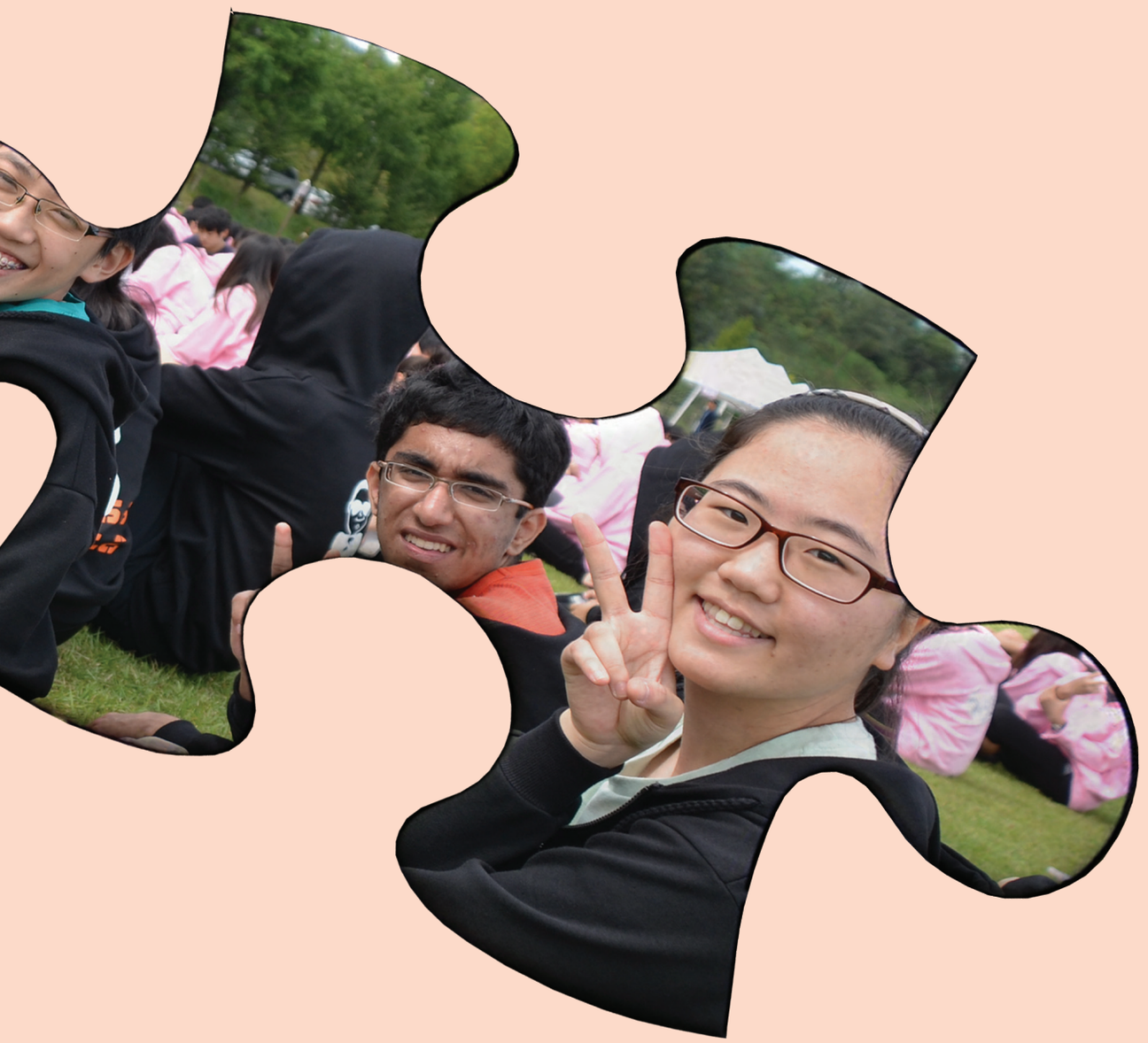
One of the greatest strengths of KMLA students is their self-management ability. And yet, when faced an excessively harsh schedule, students might experience hardship exercising this ability. This is why the students want some aid from school - to ensure that the students maintain their self-management ability and study for the test until the very last day. The school also is not deaf to student demands and seems to be willing to come to an agreement with them.

If a SAT preparatory course was a part of the regular course, it would be great. Students would be able to study SAT continuously, with no fear of not being able to study regular courses."

Park Ye-Ji
Senior Writer, 16th Wave

Interaction between KMLA and Other Schools

Learning With and From Others



Every day, KMLAians mostly encounter the same faces. Human interaction in KMLA, in such a mountainous isolation, is very limited in its scope. Yet, both the students and the school have exerted their efforts in reaching out to various sources of exchange with other schools. Especially this year, KMLA students have had much opportunity to interact with other students outside our school, even from Singapore. In this feature, Minjok Herald recollected some of the past exchange programs, interviewed students from Raffles Institution and KMLA before and after the encounter to present how the exchange programs transformed them, and examined some of the implications and further improvements that can be made with the current exchange systems. Enjoy!

By the School

Memorable, If Momentary, Sisterhood with the Mongolian School

KMLA students engage in archery with Mongolian students

Presently, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) is in a sisterhood relationship with top schools around the world like Raffles Institution of Singapore. However, before KMLA started to interact with many different schools renowned worldwide for their academic achievements, KMLA was actually in a sisterhood relationship with a Mongolian school.

In 2005, UNESCO Korean Committee launched a program to connect Korean schools with schools from underdeveloped nations. KMLA decided to become a cooperating member of the UNESCO program in 2005, and turned in a subscription for participation in the year of 2006. UNESCO Korean Committee then assigned us to a Mongolian school in a city called Kharhorin. From 2006, KMLA was in a sisterhood relationship with the Mongolian school for three years, until 2008.

During the three years in which KMLA was in a sisterhood relationship with the Mongolian school in Kharhorin, meaningful exchanges were made. Mostly, it was cultural exchange in which students of each school visited the other school. KMLA students went over to Mongol and experienced Mongolian culture, especially the beautiful nature there. KMLA students also saw for themselves the traditional house of Mongol called Ger, and went horseback riding, which is not an easy thing to do in Korea. Also, they visited the school in Kharhorin and met its students and teachers. While visiting Mongol, KMLA let its name known to the students of Mongol, and also "felt the warmth" of the Mongolian students, according to Mrs. Park Hye-Sun, who participated in the visit to Mongol. KMLA students visited a total of three times. The Mongolian students, although there were only two of them, also came over to KMLA to see how KMLA students live.

KMLA and the Mongolian school of Kharhorin had some meaningful moments in the three years of interaction. However, after three years, the sisterhood relationship was broken. Three years of sisterhood relationship was the promised period with UNESCO in the first place. But, according to Mrs. Park Hye-Sun, the passion of students to continue the interaction declined significantly by 2008.

KMLA is continuing its effort to interact with other schools internationally. Top high schools like Raffles Institution are also great to have as partners; however, we should always remember as KMLA students that excellence in academics is not everything. We must not lose our passion to share ours with others, because there is always something to learn from them. Just like how the Mongolian students reminded us of warmth in heart.

Yang Jae-Ho
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

Fusion of Sports and Cultures with KSA

Few Lineups for Participation Due to Different School Schedules

KMLA and KSA students in front of the main building of KSA

Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) and Korea Science Academy of KAIST (KSA) are building a close relationship with each other through an annual cultural and sports event. Sharing similar visions as top high schools of Korea, KMLA and KSA started having an annual event of interaction since last year.

The idea of holding an annual exchange event for the two schools was first brought up when the two headmasters of KMLA and KSA met at a Korean high school headmasters' conference. There, they agreed that students of each school, who all excel in the field of academics, should get a chance to interact with each other in different forms of exchange programs which consist of both the cultural section and the sports competition.

In the cultural exchange session, clubs from each school demonstrate their spectacular abilities on stage. KMLAian clubs that went on stage for this year's event were a *Samulnori* club, *Sa Mu Chim*, a student band, *XCL*, a vocal group, *NAB*, a hip-hop band, *Rhyme Factory*, and a cheerleading club, *KANDLES*. All of these clubs performed extraordinarily well, and students from both schools enjoyed the performances as one.

In the sports event, official clubs from each school participate in a soccer match, basketball match, and a tee ball match. The soccer match and the basketball match are played by boys, and the tee ball match is played by girls. The winning school is decided by the number of sports match won. This year, KSA took the 1st place trophy because they won the soccer and tee ball match.

The exchange event clearly has numerous advantages for the students of KMLA and KSA. The event provides a great opportunity to get rid of the stress from heavy loads of studies, and can promote a 'well-rounded' education. However, there exist some problems with the event as well. Certainly, the biggest problem is the time in which the event is held. This event was held in July this year. However, because KSA follows the schedule of KAIST, they are on vacation from June, only a few KSA students were able to participate, which significantly reduced the fun of the entire event. According to Ms. Jung Mi-Ra of KMLA, the time in which the event is held currently in is not the best time, but there are no better options. It's impossible to hold the event in May because most of the students of KMLA take the AP exams. In order for most of the students of each school to participate and make a memorable event, a change in date of the event is deemed necessary.

Yang Jae-Ho
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

Exchange with The Raffles

The Fun of Discovering Similarities and Differences

KMLA students visit Raffles Institution

No one in this world is isolated. People form close relationships with each other, helping and interacting with others und them. That is the epitome of the relationship Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) and Raffles Institution strives to develop. KMLA and Raffles had developed a sisterhood relation, supporting each other and implementing interactive programs to foster an affinity among students and teachers of both schools. Recently, the two internationally renowned institutions made a new attempt; twelve 16th wavers from KMLA flew to Singapore and attended Raffles Institution for two weeks, from July 22nd to August 4th.

In many aspects, Raffles is quite similar to KMLA in terms of its progressive education curriculum, the freedom and rights it offers its students, and its educational goal. Both KMLA and Raffles implement innovative curriculums that maximize the students' potentials. Both schools respect the students' rights, trusting them to get their jobs done and use their time wisely. In addition, both schools work to make leaders out of the students who will work for the greater good.

During the twelve KMLAians' stay at Raffles, they adopted and moved according to a regular schedule. Until 1 PM, they participated in courses with the Rafflesians, studying together with them. Then, they had lunch at the canteen, a vast hall which is nearly an equivalent of KMLA's cafeteria in the way it is used. In the afternoon, the students participated in other interesting activities, such as touring Singapore.

The twelve KMLA students found Raffles to be an interesting school with many appealing traits. "One of the most attractive characteristics of Raffles was the autonomy students could enjoy," stated Yun Ji-Hoon, one of the 16th wavers who went to Raffles. "Like KMLA, Raffles grants students independence, but on a different level. Rafflesians could support any ideas and plans as long as they are not absurd. They could even create their own events. For example, Japanese students once held a Japanese culture festival at the canteen."

Besides the rights the students could enjoy, KMLA students also noted Raffles' international atmosphere as an interesting trait. There is a diversity of culture at Raffles since its students are from all around the world. Accordingly, diverse cuisines are served at the canteen, too.

Generally, the KMLA students' trip to Raffles was a beneficial experience, both to the students from KMLA and to the students at Raffles Institution, and it has opened the door for future ties. As students of KMLA, we should take responsibilities and keep our interest for future interactions with our international buddies at Raffles.

Chang Jun-Hyuk
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

By the Students

UNESCO club members of KMLA and 7 other high schools participate in camp Now or Never

Student-Organized MUNESCO Camp Allowed Interaction with Seven Different Schools

'Now or Never' was the name of the camp held this September by the UNESCO clubs of seven schools in Seoul and regions of Gangwon province. The seven groups gathered together at KMLA and participated in interesting activities from the morning of September 1st to the afternoon of the next day. Students of *MUNESCO*, KMLA's own UNESCO club, worked together along with several other KMLA students to make the camp a success, working so that the participants could enjoy their time at KMLA during the two days.

MUNESCO was created in the April of 2005 by fifteen 10th wavers for the purpose of developing international relationships and facilitating active international interactive activities. Since then, *MUNESCO* has participated in numerous activities. *MUNESCO* works in largely seven areas: environment, human rights, peace, multiculturalism, economic justice, and regional community cultures. Currently, *MUNESCO* is participating in the Rainbow Project, a nationwide cooperative effort of UNESCO clubs, as members of the ASPnet, a joint network of UNESCO clubs. The motto of this year's Rainbow Project is "live together." Along with other ASPnet members, *MUNESCO* had been participating in several campaigns and activities to work toward that goal, including the Myungdong campaign.

The recent camp was also a part of *MUNESCO's* effort as a participant of the Rainbow Project. "Since 2008, *MUNESCO* has held a camp annually at KMLA," said Ms. Park Hye-Sun, the teacher who is in charge of *MUNESCO*. "The Korean National Committee for Unesco encourages ASPnet members to engage in UNESCO-related activities with each other. Accordingly, the UNESCO clubs of Seoul and regions of Gangwon province, including *MUNESCO*, had decided to have our own camp." As for the name of the camp, 'Now or Never,' Ms. Park commented, "The meaning behind the name is that we must take action now. The time for making efforts toward a better world should not be reserved; it is now or never."

After students from other schools arrived at KMLA, they had time to organize their luggage at the Changui Hall and eat lunch at the cafeteria. Schools who wanted a tour of KMLA were guided through the school by *MUNESCO* member. Then, all participating teachers and students gathered at the Dasan Hall, where each of the seven schools was given some time to share its plans and ideas. Afterwards, students were assigned into groups, and each group prepared a skit based on one of the seven themes they were given. After having a barbeque party at the Changui Building, the groups presented their skits. The next day, the students had time to create rolling papers for each other and to build memories together.

An important aspect of the camp was that it was planned and led by students almost entirely by students. "If school administration had prepared the camp, there is a possibility that it might have been too focused on educating the students," stated Park Ye-Ji, the 16th waver who led *MUNESCO* activities until September. "Since students created the agenda and prepared the event, the camp was enjoyable to many students, thus captivating their interests and naturally leading to passionate participation." Indeed, the camp seems to have been an enjoyable and meaningful experience for the participants. "Students would have learned that a change inside me can change the world," answered Park when questioned what students would have learned from the camp. "They would have a chance to think a lot about both current and future activities."

Although *MUNESCO* members are taking active actions toward a better world, the responsibility is not only theirs. We must keep in mind that we live together, and we are also responsible for our world.

Chang Jun-Hyuk
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

16th waver Kim Seung-Jun plays the drums in the KMLA Rock Festival

Rock Festival Losing Its Power to Fill Up Both the Seats and the Stage

You could feel the drum beats thumping your heart, dynamic guitar sounds roaring in your ears, and ebullient reactions from the crowd. This is what happened at April 1st during the Rock Festival that was held in the auditorium of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA).

The event was first held by the 10th wavers of KMLA to promote active interaction among schools through music and most importantly, create a haven for music fans who want to show off their musical talents. Bands from other special purpose high schools participated in this year's Rock Festival and added extra amusement and fervor to the performances. Songs performed by various bands ranged from cute modern rock like IU's '*It-Ja-Nah*' to heavy rock songs such as Michael Jackson's 'Beat it.'

Students from other schools perform for the KMLA Rock Festival

For the last few years, the Rock Festival of KMLA has created an opportunity for students who are overloaded with schoolwork and competitions to relieve their stress. Rock, the genre of the music itself, allows the students to escape from the reality and let music take their minds away. It also allowed students from various schools and backgrounds to blend into one through music. If not through the festival, students of other high schools would have no chance to perform their talents and different music styles to KMLAians. After all, the Rock Festival opens a novel way of interaction.

Unfortunately, the Rock Festival of 2012 was not flawless but rather brought up certain issues to the table. First of all, there is only limited number of schools, mostly special purpose high schools that participate in the festival. Although the members of different bands try their best to show diverse selection of songs to the audiences, the meaning of Rock Festival fades away if students from ordinary high schools can't enjoy this event together. Second, the number of audiences is dwindling. A lot of the 13th wavers and 14th wavers, regardless of whether they are international or domestic students, filled the whole performance room, jumping around and screaming fervently in the auditorium. However, this year, only one-third of the audiences visited the auditorium and even some of them left in the middle of the performance, leaving the room vacant. On top of that, majority of the students were strongly against the idea that a small portion of the student funds be used to finance the Rock Festival. As a result, the two official bands of KMLA, *PLZ* and FITM, barely managed to run the event by receiving donations from students in the cafeteria.

While the Rock festival has promoted musical exchange with students outside KMLA, the problems aforementioned should be solved soon. Hopefully, following festivals will provide a more stable and meaningful concert for the students inside and outside KMLA.

Kim Seung-Jun
Staff Feature Writer, 16th Wave

From the Rafflesian's Perspective

Interview with Raffles Student Representative Marc Leong

Hwang Ye-Seul
Staff Feature Writer,
16th Wave

From September 9th to 22nd, Raffles Institution visited Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) to exchange with the KMLA students. A total of twelve Singapore students and one teacher, Mr. Sze, participated in the exchange. *Minjok Herald* held an interview with the student representative, Marc Leong. The interview consists of two parts: interview before the exchange and after the exchange.

Before the Exchange

This summer, KMLA students visited Raffles Institution. What was it like?
Yes, the KMLA students came over to our school earlier this year from late July to early August. I think it was great spending time with and getting to know our buddies during the exchange program. Even though our buddies had different class schedules, we accompanied them on the field trips organized by our school. We also planned activities for them during the weekend. I think each of us learned more about life in KMLA through our conversations with them. At the end of the program, we couldn't wait to fly over to KMLA and see our new friends once again!

What is your first impression on Korea? Incheon Airport? KMLA? How was it different from what you had in mind?
Well, the first thing we noticed about Korea was the lovely weather you guys have here. It was a welcome change from the heat and humidity we face every day in Singapore. We didn't get to see much of the airport, but we managed to catch a glimpse of the mask dance show in the airport's foyer. When we arrived at KMLA, we were awed by the natural beauty surrounding the school. There are no mountains and grasslands in Singapore, as we are a small and highly urbanized nation, so it was a pleasant surprise to be greeted with such beautiful mountain scenery. I think most of us expected that the school be smaller, judging from what we heard from the buddies, as well as our estimation from the size of our own campus. We were thus shocked at the size of the KMLA grounds, housing, many buildings, and sports facilities.

You are going to stay here for two weeks. What do you expect from this exchange?
As our teacher Mr. Sze mentioned at Monday's assembly, we are here to learn more about the Korean culture, as well as to study here at one of the top schools in Korea. However, I hope our trip will also be a meaningful experience for our classmates, buddies and the KMLA family. All of us are open to sharing our experiences in Singapore, and although we may be shy at times, we hope to make many lasting friendships with KMLA students. We are really excited about the next two weeks with you all!

After the Exchange

Your trip has finally ended. What does it feel like?
I think it's really sad that our trip has ended. We really enjoyed our time here, and we learned many new things! We wish we could stay here for another week If we spend another week, I think we will be able to experience more things in Korea.

What is one activity that you enjoyed the most in KMLA?
We learned how to play the Korean traditional drums, Samulnori, and I found it really fun to play the drums together with the KMLA students. At first, I thought the music was a bit loud, but as I played with the students, I found myself enjoying it.

What is one activity that you found quite shocking?
De Kai, one of our group members, celebrated his birthday during the trip, and he was shocked by how KMLA students, especially the guys, celebrate their birthdays! After De Kai blew out his candles, a guy pushed De Kai's head into the cake. De Kai's face was covered all over with cake! When Seah Yi celebrated his birthday the next week, we knew what to expect.

Raffles Student Representative Marc Leong on the school track

How did you like KMLA?
I found KMLA to be a really great place to learn. The lessons are interesting and the students have a lot of opportunity to learn on their own. I really learned many new lessons from this experience and I really loved being a part of the school, although it was only for two weeks.

What is one unique feature that KMLA has?
KMLA is very unique because it's located in the mountains and far from anything else. The mountains gave us a big impression when we first arrived at KMLA. This makes it very different from Singapore and other schools, and it is a very different way of life.

How was Seoul?
Seoul is a very beautiful place. We saw a palace and took many pictures, but I think the best part was when we went shopping at Insadong! We are really grateful to the DIA students who planned the trip for us. There were so much to see, hear, and experience.

Do you wish to continue such exchange?
Of course we do! We would love to continue this exchange for years to come, so that many Raffles students can also experience KMLA. We really want to share the lessons we have learned with more generations of Rafflesians and KMLA students.

What do you think is the best thing that you attained through this exchange?
The friendships that we made with the KMLA students are the biggest advantage from the exchange. All of us have gotten closer to our new friends and we want to keep in touch far into the future! Thanks so much KMLA!

From the KMLAian's Perspective

Interview with 16th Waver Kim Nu-Ri

Hwang Hye-Jung
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

Do you remember the handful of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) students that had volunteered to go to Singapore during their summer vacation? As a return visit, a group of students from Raffles Institution have visited our school. The Raffles students' visit to Korea was a special occurrence not only in their side, but on KMLA's as well. Especially members of the Office of International Affairs(OIA), who organized and accompanied the Raffles students' tours to Seoul and Gyeongju, have had an invaluable experience. A member of the OIA, Kim Nu-Ri, has agreed to share the changes in her thoughts before and after participating in the exchange program with the Raffles students.

How did you come to participate in the Raffles exchange?
The OIA is a group of students who take part in basically all of the events that are related to KMLA and another school. I have been working for the OIA since I was a freshman, which is how I came to be involved in the Raffles exchange. From the end of last year I had heard that the students from Raffles were coming to KMLA. The OIA has been preparing for this for a long time. We reserved, scheduled and phoned everything related to their visit: accommodations, tourist attractions, transportations, and other things as well.

What did you think about Raffles and Singapore before you actually met the students?
To admit, I did not know a lot about the school before I met the students in person. I merely had heard that Raffles was the best school in Singapore, and that it was a boys' school. I thought of Singapore as a small but strong country, with a lot of potential.

What was your first impression of the Raffles students?
As I said, I did not know a lot about Singapore and Raffles. I was a bit surprised at first, because I thought that a lot of Singaporeans were white. The students had a refined, gentleman-like manner, and wore white shirts that were creaseless and cleanly ironed, matching their decent behavior. They stood straight and did not play during the morning assembly.

What do you expect from the following two weeks of exchange?
I want to achieve further understanding of each other's countries. There are not many high schools like KMLA that provide exchange opportunities with other schools, as far as I know. I want to use this chance well. I want to know more about their culture, and am curious how the different cultures, though Korea and Singapore are both Asian countries, might influence education in separate ways. I am eagerly looking forward to interacting with Singaporean students!

Can you give some examples of the activities you joined the Raffles students in?
The OIA had to plan and execute their entire schedule, attended the Seoul and Gyeongju tours, talked to the Raffles students as friends, and I even got to help them academically because I was the only member of the OIA who took the same class with them. For Mr.Ganse's class, I helped Raffles students make their presentations. The Seoul and Gyeongju tours were the most arduous; the OIA created everything from the scratch, from preliminary research to reserving restaurants, booking accommodations, and interpreting them extemporaneously, all the while keeping everything within our budget.

How do you think the experiences above influenced you?
I feel that I achieved my initial goal of getting to know a different culture better, and learned a lot in the process. It was a rare opportunity to interact with Southeastern Asian culture, while other cultures like British or American culture can be met more easily through sources like literature. Also, it was a chance to meet foreign students of similar social status of our age; it was helpful to learn about how the students our age from other countries would view the world and education.

Will you participate in the exchange program if another exchange program is to be scheduled in the future?
Most certainly! I think becoming a member of the OIA is one of the best things I have done since I came to KMLA. Organizing the exchange was not easy, but I feel that this experience has trained and matured me.

Is there anything you wish to improve in an exchange program with another school in the future?
First, I hope the school pay more attention and help out the OIA in organizing the event. The school did care a lot after the Raffles students arrived to KMLA, but Mr. Menard really went through a lot of trouble in planning everything because of the lack of attention. Since foreign exchange events can be very beneficial, I hope the school would support us more on holding international exchange programs.
Additionally, I want to encourage KMLA students to become more active in engaging with foreign students when there is an opportunity like this exchange. I felt that only the buddies and OIA members were the ones talking to the Raffles students, and normal students would not step up to talk to the Raffles students. I only saw a few students in the International Field start a conversation, but I could count those students on my finger. I think the Raffles students would have found it easier to assimilate if normal students actively engaged in daily conversations.

16th waver and DIA member, Kim Nu-Ri

OIA & School Promotion Group

Profile of OIA

Overseer and Executor of International Affairs

Kim Seung-Jun
Staff Feature Writer, 16th Wave

Not many people in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) are aware of the roles and values of Office of International Affairs (OIA). In fact, some students do not even know the existence of it. The following content will hopefully allow KMLA family to grasp clearly what OIA is and to get rid of the misconceptions they might have had in the past.

OIA oversees and executes all interactions at the international level. The responsibilities of OIA range from official correspondence to promotion of KMLA internationally, including the creation of promotional materials such as school brochures. It also develops inter-school relationships, creates new relationships with other schools internationally and maintains contacts with various educational bodies. It is also in charge of school tours for international visitors, and of course organizing student and teacher exchanges.

The most obvious return on the investment in international relations is increased awareness of our school, which is great when we participate in international competitions and of course when we apply to overseas universities. Mr. Menard remarks, "KMLA is well known in Korea, and our aim is to also make KMLA equally well known abroad." As for exchanges, this not only gives KMLA students opportunities to visit and experience other top schools but also to meet peers from abroad. Ideally, relationships can be formed which may last well into students' professional careers. Also, having exchange teachers allows students from KMLA to gain different perspectives on various subject matters while experiencing different teaching styles.

Basically, OIA members assist the department in organizing events for international visitors, translating official documents, brainstorming future goals for International Public Relations (IPR), and recruiting new members of OIA. Recently, the current members of OIA joined the group from Raffles Institution as they went to Gyeongju, Seoul, and Everland, field trips that they helped organize.

OIA usually conducts interviews in late November; each candidate is interviewed by Mr. Menard, and the coordinator, Mr. Hinde. The candidate is then interviewed by the current members of OIA. According to Mr. Menard, OIA is primarily looking for people with strong school spirit, diplomatic skills, and an awareness of KMLA's history. It's because, often, volunteers will be asked about KMLA by visitors, so they need to be aware of the history and know how to respond appropriately as representatives of KMLA to any questions visitors may have. He also added that DIA needs students who can devote themselves to IPR with passion and integrity.

What are future plans of OIA? First, it will be deepening KMLA's relationship with Raffles by organizing regular student exchanges, as well as inviting a teacher from Raffles to stay with us for a semester. One of the teachers from KMLA will also visit Raffles in the same capacity. It is also going to be assisting in the development of the new English website and school promotional video, while also considering sister school relations with other schools. It is also working at deepening relationships with the other G20 schools, a global organization of top schools. And of course, Mr. Menard told us that he hopes to continue giving the students opportunities to gain hands on experience in international public relations by recruiting more volunteers.

Profile of School Promotion Goup

Advertising KMLA from Inside

Kim Jung-Hoon
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

We all know that Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) is a great school. But do others? In order to spread the existence of KMLA further away, it has become a necessity to make a division that would be responsible of advertising the school.

"I've been working in the Office of Public Relations (OPR) since this year." says Ms. Jeong Seon-Hee, the total manager of the School Promotion Group. "Since the school started its weekend-tours, I've noticed that one of the main interests of the tourists was the enrolling student's life in KMLA. After careful consideration, I've thought that it would be effective to help the students introduce the school themselves." Ms. Jeong emphasized the fact that the whole idea of the School Promotion Group actually stemmed from several students that felt the need to actively participate in enhancing the school's image.

Ms.Jeong Seon-Hee, the total administrator of the School Promotion Group

There are mainly three aspects that the School Promotion Group is responsible for. One is the week-end tour of KMLA. Every month, there are two tours guided by KMLA students, introducing the school's diverse buildings and unique characteristics. Another part of the School Promotion Group is making a modified version of the school's advertisement UCC. "We are currently in the process of making a synopsis, and we are almost finished with it!" says Lee Jun-Seok, who is taking part in making the UCC. The rest of the School Promotion Group members are focusing on changing the school homepage. "There have been numerous changes compared to the last modification version that was presented about three years ago. Therefore, it should be updated in order for outsiders to acknowledge the activities going on in KMLA. We are frequently arranging meetings with the web-master, discussing specific plans on what to do." says Lee.

According to a survey given to the 17th wave, many say that they've heard about the School Promotion Group, yet have no idea what kinds of activities the School Promotion Group is participating in. "Of course we aren't noticeable yet. The School Promotion Group was established only about four to five months ago. We are still working on the UCCs and the school homepage." says Ms. Jeong. "However, we do believe that as some of our main purposes are achieved, the student body will start to recognize the School Promotion Group as an official department that contributes much for the school." says Kim Suh-Young, a member of the School Promotion Group.

It seems as if the future of the School Promotion Group is shining. First of all, it has a great chief executor and a great motive—to introduce the brand new KMLA—that would allow KMLA to be recognized as the best school to bring about new global leaders. In addition, the School Promotion Group members are working as hard as they could to improve the school's methods, despite of the student's low rate of interest. Finally, it has a concrete and practical image of what it is planning to do for the future. School Promotion Group is the solution for solving misleading comments against KMLA – a solution the school has been searching for a long time.

Suggestions for Future Exchange Programs

'Win-Win Deal'

Both Schools Learning, Adopting, and Changing for the Better

Suh Dong-In
Staff Feature Writer, 16th Wave

Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) experienced two major exchange programs this year. One was with KSA (Korean Science Academy) and the other was with Raffles Institution, which is located in Singapore. Though the events took place on a relatively short schedule, there was no problem in achieving the goal of establishing a communal bond between the schools.

In the case of the exchange programs held at KSA, both schools were able to compete and cooperate with one another through the sports competitions such as soccer, basketball, teeball, and tug-of-war. Both schools played in a fair manner, showing true sportsmanship. Regardless of the scores and results, the participants of the matches were able to establish intimate relationships with one another after enjoying the games. The event was also meaningful by the fact that students could reconsider the true meaning of sportsmanship and actually show sportsmanship by themselves. In the cultural integration programs, both schools were able to enjoy the performances of dance groups and bands. Everyone at the program was able to get along with each other freely, regardless of the schools they were from. It was surely a program that united the students as one, which helped to build a strong bond between the two schools.

KMLA also had active exchange programs with Raffles Institution as well. After the 2nd semester began, 12 students from Raffles Institution came to Korea. These students stayed in KMLA for two weeks and participated in many different programs. Though two weeks was not that long of a time, the students from Raffles were able to integrate with KMLA very well. Many KMLA students actually enjoyed the integration programs and were sad to part with the Raffles Institution's students after the two weeks had passed.

Both programs had great significance for KMLA. These programs definitely played a role in establishing a foundation for future advancements in the bonds between these two schools. Interacting and sharing strong bonds with different schools can be advantageous in many ways. The events that happened this year will serve as a stepping stone for such future prospects. In a microscopic viewpoint, these events certainly played a role in helping each student develop his social and cooperative skills. Students were also able to make new friends who had different interests and ideas. Through a rather macroscopic viewpoint, the schools that participated in the interaction programs were able to confirm a firm bond between one another and share different interests.

The exchange programs that were held this year can be viewed similar to the twinning between two cities or universities. The major goal of the 'twinning' processes is to achieve development by learning from each other and to exchange cultural differences. Similar to this, the exchange programs held between KMLA, KSA, and Raffles Institution can also become a 'win-win deal' for each school. Like the successful cases of 'twinning', we can also expect a fruitful prospective for both schools participating in the exchange programs. KMLA can adopt new educational systems, teaching mechanisms, and curriculums, which will eventually help the school improve. In addition, if such programs are continued on, it will be a great opportunity for students who were not able to study abroad and experience foreign culture. These are why the exchange programs were so significant and will be even more significant to KMLA in the future.

Student Body and the School Should Act Together for Long Lasting Interaction

Kim Jung-Hoon
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

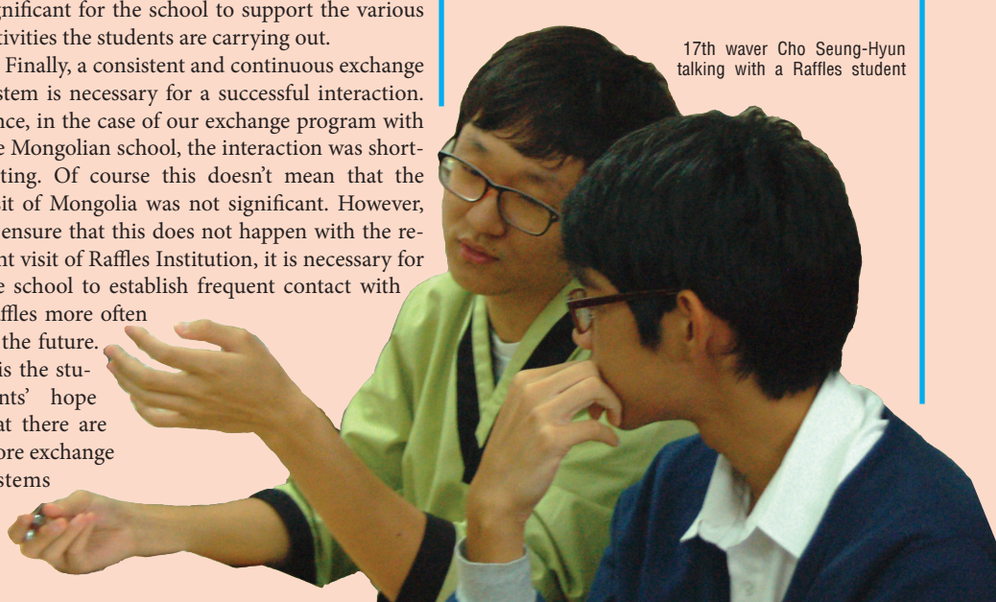
Recently in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA), there have been diverse exchange programs that allowed other students to experience KMLA's traditional aspects and interact with KMLA's students. In order to maintain a great reputation and to keep up with the present interactions, it is important to regain our strength and our school's important values. In order to achieve these values, the two bodies of KMLA - the students and the faculty - must cooperate.

On the student's side of the matter, it is important for all of the enrolled students to feel pride in our school. KMLA is very unique since it has various traditions that characterize our school. For instance, KMLA is famous for its English Only Policy (EOP), which is distinctive from other schools. As its name explains, the EOP is a policy in which the students in KMLA are required to use English during their usual hours. However, EOP is becoming less and less enforced in KMLA and sometimes rouse antipathy for it giving out penalty points to violators. However, for KMLA to continue on its great reputation, it is important to pass on our special tradition with pride. This fundamentally has to start within the student body.

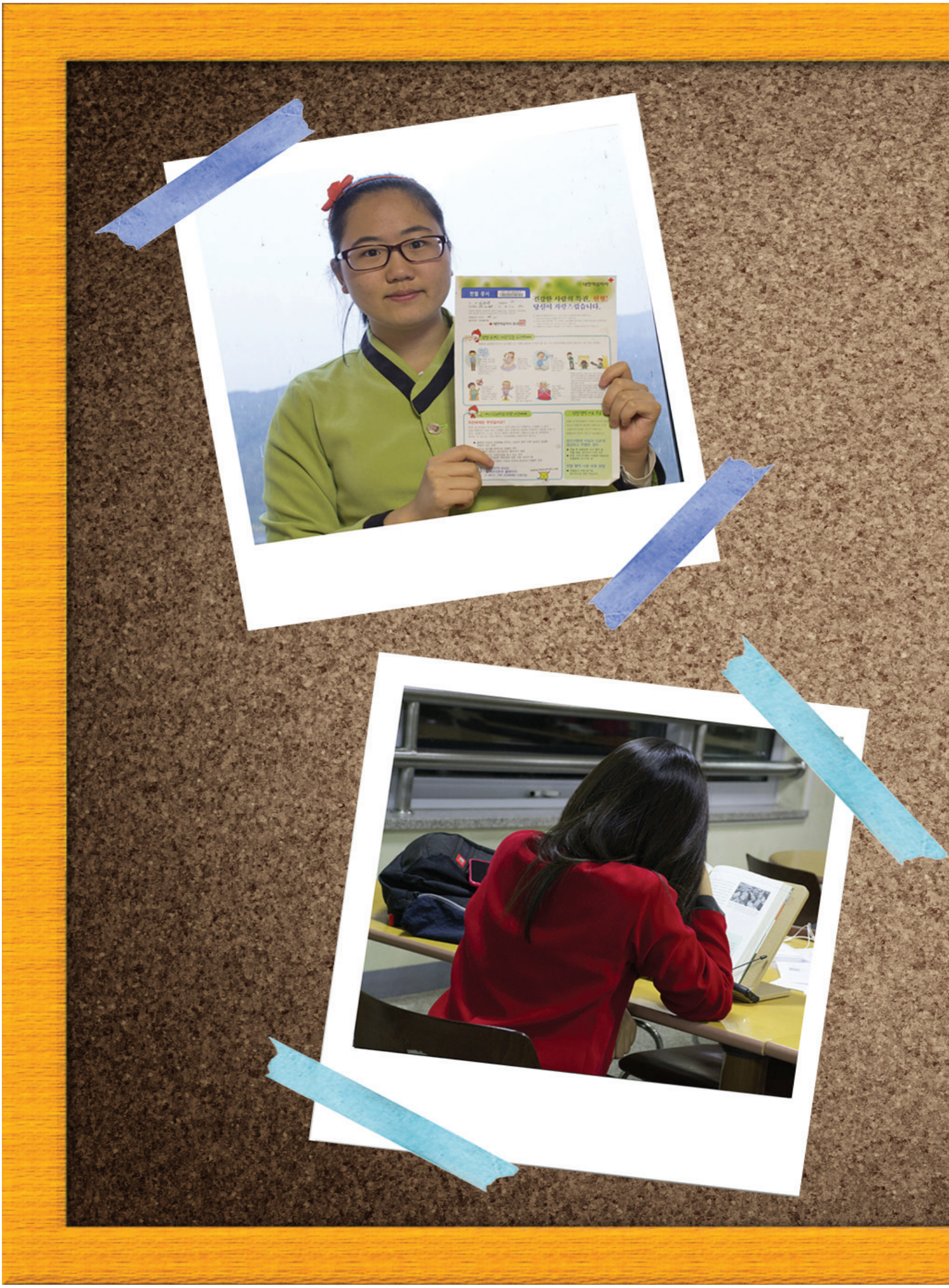
The students are not the only ones that need to work on boosting the school's advantages. The faculty members of KMLA also have to support the students in active interactions with Office of International Affairs (OIA) and School Promotion Group that would help out on KMLA's image. However, there are opinions that express hope for school-wise financial support. Ms. Jeong Seon-Hee, the overall advisor of the School Promotion Group says that "we definitely would like some kind of financial support if it were provided by the school." The students in KMLA are already involved in advertising the school. Hence, it is significant for the school to support the various activities the students are carrying out.

Finally, a consistent and continuous exchange system is necessary for a successful interaction. Once, in the case of our exchange program with the Mongolian school, the interaction was short-lasting. Of course this doesn't mean that the visit of Mongolia was not significant. However, to ensure that this does not happen with the recent visit of Raffles Institution, it is necessary for the school to establish frequent contact with Raffles more often in the future. It is the students' hope that there are more exchange systems with diverse schools which would allow KMLA to broaden the school's horizon.

KMLA is a very distinctive and prestigious school with many merits. In order to spread our school's image further throughout the world, in the international field, it is suggested that both the students and faculty make efforts to advertise the school's bright vision and future, by hosting deep consistent exchange programs.



17th waver Cho Seung-Hyun talking with a Raffles student



Tips for Taking Good Pictures

Provided by the Minjok Herald Photocrew

1. Seven pictures: It is commonly known that practice is much more important than natural talent. This rule also applies to photography. Composition, quality of light, and expression of the pictures develop in direct proportion to the number of pictures. Try to take least seven pictures of one subject. If you do so, you will definitely find yourself as a better photographer.

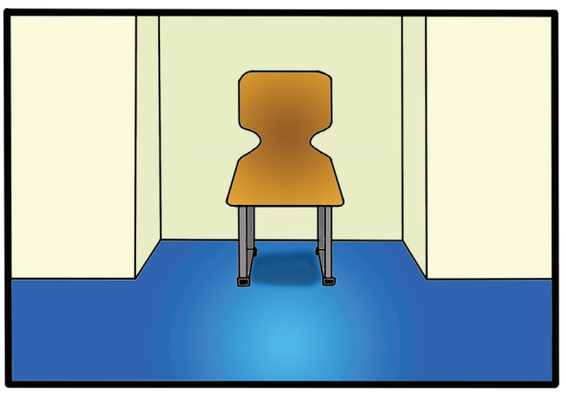
2. Attention: Many people say there's nothing to take pictures of in their daily lives. However, with just a bit of your attention and observation, you will discover that there are hundreds of different images of the object. Paying attention reveals all the different aspects of an object, which then provides you with infinite ways to express yourself.

3. Creativity: One of the most important elements of the newspaper is readability. Photographs - especially press photos - also have to be easy to understand. To do this, try to think creatively. People always are attracted to "new things." Think outside the box. Try out new compositions or colors that can perfectly express your own thoughts.

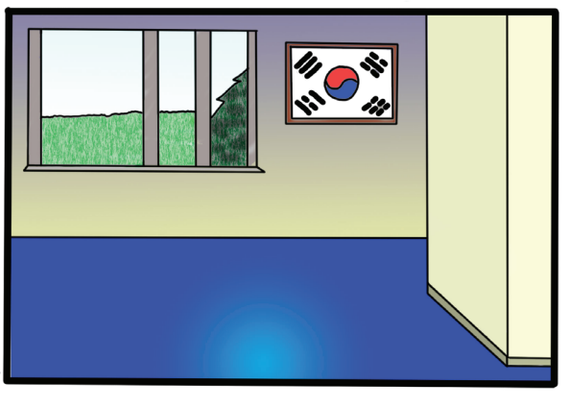
4. Be yourself: There is no answer in photography. All photographers out there are just struggling to take a 'better' picture. Don't be afraid. Believe in yourself and press the shutter of the camera with confidence.

KMLA Boys N Girls

Episode 1. Honjeong



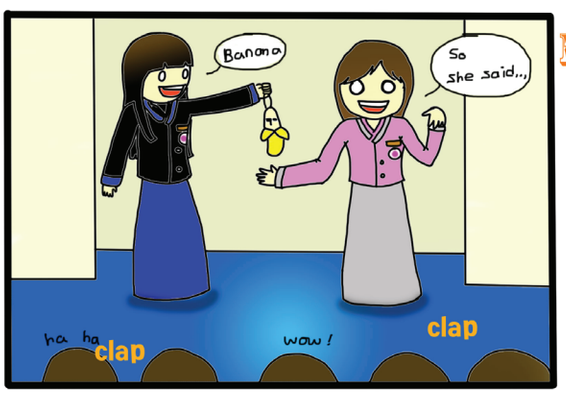
Honjeong: a time for KMLAians to give goodnight bows to their dorm parents and notify important announcements. However, there are significant gender differences.



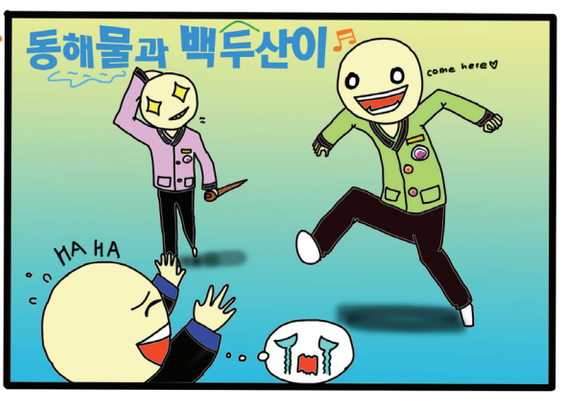
9:15

START

9:13

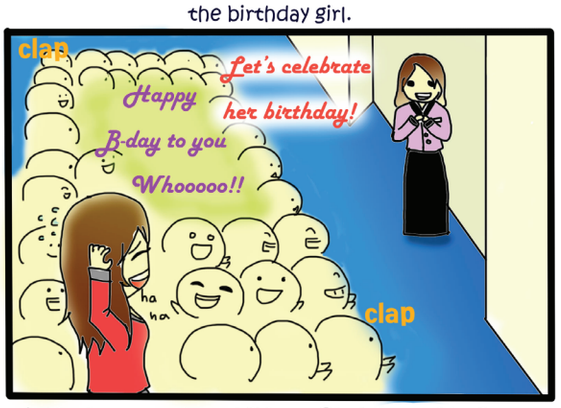


BIRTHDAY

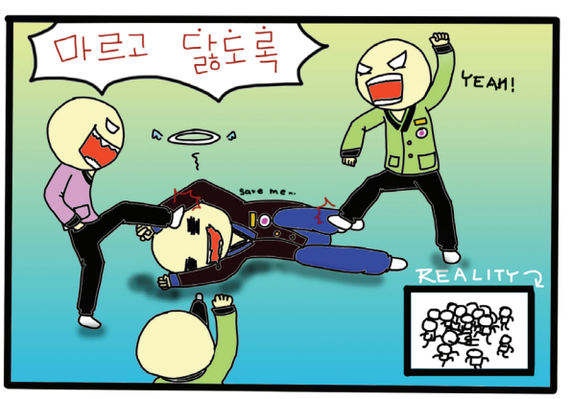


Girls perfrom simple plays to congratulate the birthday girl.

The Korean national anthem starts to echo throughout the room as boys approach their prey.

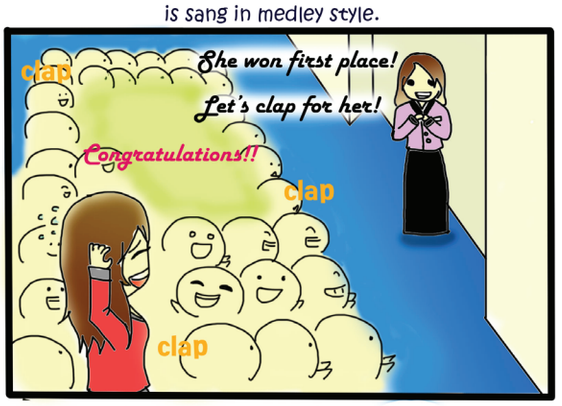


A *Honjeong* version of "Happy Birthday to You" rap is sang in medley style.

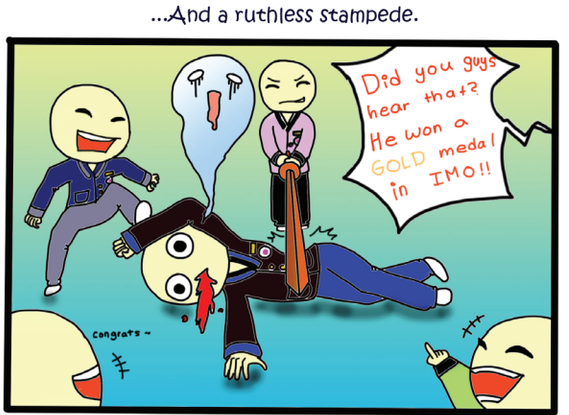


...And a ruthless stampede.

AWARDS



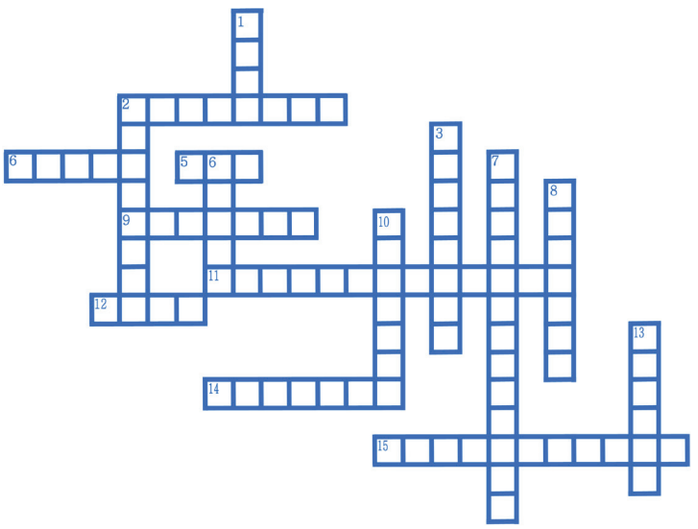
Similarly, loud claps fill the air.



...Another stampede

(The better the awards are the more you need life insurance)

KMLA Crossword



Across

02. What is the oldest building on KMLA campus?
04. What is the name of garment that Mr. Moon wears on his head?
05. How many boys appeared in the editor-in-chief's birthday announcement?
09. What city is Mr. Hinde's wife from?
11. KMLAians like to call IR not Individual Research but _____ _____.
12. During the Three Generation Athletics Meeting, students found out that Mr. Garrioch did not like which color?
14. What are the two words the headmaster said to the Raffles students during the September 10th morning assembly?
15. What did Mr. Hinde receive from his advisees as a wedding gift?

Down

01. What is the four-letter word that many 16th wave males tend to use often?
02. The school's swimming pool is located near which building?
03. What is Mr. Wayne Baumgardner's favorite animal?
06. What is the first name of the person whose hand is in the picture in page 30?
07. What do KMLAians "never say no to?"
08. What was Mr. Kim Dae-Ki's occupation before he came to KMLA?
10. What is one outside food KMLAians get to eat legally once a month?
13. In rememberance of Mr. Johnson, Mr. Johnson's last departing words were, "I love you all and remember to take care of your _____"

Find out the answers in the next issue!

Communicative Nutritionist, from Adjustment to Revolution

How Does Our Food Come to Be?

On the morning of September 3rd, a thunder of applause filled the gymnasium of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) – new teachers have arrived to become a part of the KMLA family. *Minjok Herald* interviewed the "cook" of the new family, Ms. Go Hyun-Mi, to find out about her as a person, her job in general, and her vision for KMLA's daily sustenance.

Minjok Herald: *Please tell us about your daily routine.*
Ms. Go Hyun-Mi: I come to my office at around 8 o'clock morning and re-check whether the ingredients I have ordered in the previous day is correct. Then the ingredients are delivered from about eight thirty to nine. Then, I read and fill out some official notices. At about 11, I test the food that is to be served. My lunch time varies, but normally it is around 11:40. During the lunch time until 2 o'clock, I take care of the students in cafeteria. Afterwards, I work: schedule the school meal menu, make subscriptions, fill out official notices, and order food for the next day.

MH: *How do you exactly schedule our school menu?*
Ms. Go: Using the NEIS program, I type in the scheduled food for each day. Then, the total number of calories appears in the system. If this exceeds the total nutritional requirements for an average high school student, I remove some food and add in another food to balance nutritional requirements.

MH: So when you are scheduling the food, you type in the food that comes to mind?
Ms. Go: For a start, yes. But I also consider people's preference of the food. For example, I put meat or another more favorable food in the place of fish because I observed that two out of ten people do not eat fish.

MH: *Some of the students think that the school menus did not undergo a lot of changes even after your arrival. Are you planning to change anything?*
Ms. Go: Well, currently, I am adjusting to the school. After this moment passes, I am definitely going to change school meal menus considering the students' and teacher's preferences.

MH: *We saw that sometimes, the meals do not come out as planned in the school menus posted online. Can you tell us why this happens?*
Ms. Go: This happens sometimes because the quality of ingredient is not as good as I have expected. Then they are automatically excluded from the school meal menus. The second case is when ingredients failed to make in time like when a heavy rain deters the import of pineapples. Lastly, there are my mistakes. This happens frequently these days since I am still adjusting to school. However, I believe I should be extremely careful and always be attentive that every food fits to the school meal menus.

MH: *When is the most difficult moment working as a nutritionist?*
Ms. Go: Everyday, actually. (Laugh) Well, when there is excessive amount of work to do, it is quite hard to manage all of them. For example, this week I needed to schedule the school meal menu, prepare for the barbecue party the Singaporeans, fill out an official notice, and prepare food for Three Generation Athletic Meeting, all the while surveying the eating habits and preparing food for exchange students from Singapore. Like this, when work from various places suddenly piles up, keeping up with my original work and successfully managing others is quite difficult.

MH: *We would think that preparing the exact amount of food for all the students and faculty to eat is pretty difficult. How do you deal with the distribution of food?*
Ms. Go: The ordering of meal occurs this way: if there is a sign beside the dumplings that says "take three," it means that I ordered 3*(student number + faculty number) dumplings. So if all the members of our school take only three, then the food is all well distributed without anyone who did not have a chance to eat the dumplings. I think this depends on each student's conscience. When a student sees the sign that says how much food to take, then he or she should do as the sign says. To gain this mindset, guidance from teachers and me may be needed, such as frequently telling students to have this fair state of mind.

MH: *Lastly, what would you like to say to the students, parents, teachers, and school worker's who will be reading Minjok Herald?*
Ms. Go: Even though our school has a self-regulated distribution of food, I hope students will fairly take their portions. When I adjust to the system and gain stability, I am really looking forward to listening to students' opinions and apply them when scheduling the school menu. I will make the most of this experience and really try to work hard for the improvement of students' health.

Jeon So-Yeon
Staff Writer, 16th Wave

New school nutrionist, Ms. Go Hyun-Mi

Kisa, More than Just a Sport

Interview with KMLA's Horseback Rider Jang Su-A

Since the entrance of the 17th wavers, Jang Su-A, a 17th waver who plays a unique sport, attracted many students' attention. After she won the gold medal in horseback riding game in Gangwon Sports Festival, students' curiosity about her is increasing. This time, *Minjok Herald* interviewed Jang Su-A to find more about her and this unique sport.

Minjok Herald: *So, many students are very interested in this sport you play,* Kisa *(Mounted archery). Can you briefly explain it to us?*
Jang Su-A: Well, I don't know if I can call it a type of sport. I think it is more of a type of martial arts. Basically, *Kisa* consists of two parts – horseback riding and archery. Since I do the traditional style *Kisa*, the type of archery is also traditional Korean type. You can just imagine those people in *Soo-ryub-do* of *Moo-yong-chong*. What they do is Kisa.

MH: *Speaking of* Moo-yong-chong*, is there anything special about the history of* Kisa*?*
Jang: I don't know well about the history of *Kisa*, though I did learn about it. *Kisa* is a very old tradition, as you can see from *Moo-yong-chong*, and our ancestors protected our country in this way. I suppose I'm going to learn more about the history of *Kisa* in this semester, since I'm writing a history paper about it.

MH: *Is the paper for Mr. Ganse's class? What is the exact topic?*
Jang: Yes, it is for Mr. Ganse's class. Actually, he recommended me to write about *Kisa*. The topic is comparison between Korean Mounted Archery, *Kisa*, and Mounted Archery of other countries. Many countries have this tradition of Mounted Archery and each country has its unique way.

MH: Kisa *is a very unusual thing to enjoy as a hobby. How did you get involved in* Kisa*?*
Jang: Before I started *Kisa*, I always had an interest in horses and martial arts. I came to know about *Kisa* by chance, and I immediately decided to try it. So I started *Kisa* when I was 12 years old.

MH: *I heard that* Kisa *is very difficult since one needs to do horseback riding and archery at the same time. Was there any difficulty while learning it?*
Jang: Yes, it is difficult. Of course, that I have to do both at the same time is hard, but I think the most difficult part is that *Kisa* is not something that I do alone. I have to do it with horses. Taking care of the horses while I'm shooting an arrow is the hardest part. Despite these difficulties, I think I could learn it without big trouble since my teacher led me enthusiastically with strong will.

MH: *It seems like you spend a lot of time with horses doing Kisa. Are the horses that you spend time with special to you?*
Jang: Yes, they are special to me, certainly. I came to have strong attachment to some horses. You know, after I ride them several times, horses get to know me and recognize me. That's when I am impressed deeply.

MH: *Can you tell us about the Kisa competition that you entered this year?*
Jang: The competition I entered is an international competition that is held once a year. All the rules are based on the military competition that our ancestors took in the past. This time, it was 8th competition and was held on August. I started to enter this competition since the 4th one. I did not win the prize, but I took 8th place among more than 40 participants. In fact, winning the prize in this competition is quite difficult since there is no separation between men and women or adult and students. So I have to compete with all types of people, including the teachers who teach someone like me.

MH: *How was the horseback riding game in Gangwon Sports Festival?*
Jang: Well, I would say that it was kind of confusing at first. Above all, the game that I had to play was an obstacle race on horseback. However, I have never done that type of game. Also, I have been riding small ponies, the ones that you can see in Jeju Island, but I suddenly had to ride huge western horses. Therefore, during the game, I was very poor at dealing with horses and felt so sorry about it. Because I did not expect anything after doing so poorly, I was very surprised when I got the gold medal.

MH: *Before we finish this interview, tell us if you want to say anything lastly.*
Jang: I feel awkward to say this, but I want to say that *Kisa* is more than just a simple sport. *Kisa* is the way that our ancestors used to protect this country. It is succession of Korean tradition and has a special meaning in terms of culture.

Choi Ye-Rin
Staff Writer, 16th Wave

17th waver Jang Su-A fully dressed in the traditional Korean Kisa attire

Trapped in the Mountains?

A Contemplation on the Seclusion of KMLA

Lee Chung-Hyun
Staff Opinion Writer, 16th Wave

Outside the main gate lies an endless, and sometimes lonely, road with its borders smothered with unknown wild flowers. It's only the cars visiting the Korean Minjok Leadership Academy that pass by, and sometimes tractors or trucks transporting animals would show up. A few minute walk into the woods surrounding the school leads to the sudden feeling of 'lostness' and isolation due to the highly grown oak trees and sporadically intruding wild animals. This is what the area little beyond the boundaries of KMLAians' lives looks like – a good reason for students to describe the school as 'secluded.'

Living in the Gangwon province, where the density of factories and industrial complexes is relatively low, and especially in the mountains, means that the overall environment students live in is better than those of most other schools. Residing in a better environment means being able to breathe in more clean and fresh air when you go on a walk early in the morning, being able to see more stars glittering in the night sky, and being able to rest under a shadow of a big chestnut tree, enjoying a more gentle and cool breeze in the middle of a summer.

The isolation sometimes works as a student-friendly factor in school life. Because the school is far out of reach of the area densely populated by people, students experience less sound pollution and light pollution generally inevitable in urban areas. Moreover, isolation from cities and other people also mean separation from academies and demanding parents. This fact may actually help students to learn how to study by themselves and how to manage their own schedules and become more responsible with the choices they make.

In addition, seclusion from what we would call 'modern civilization'"tends to strengthen the relations within the school community. As time passes, not only do the students have more opportunity to work together in school doing various activities, but also students begin to rely on each other more than on other people living farther away. Isolation may be one of the reasons why we call ourselves the 'KMLA Family.'

However, not all students view such seclusion positively, especially when it comes to 'supplies,' including adequate food and necessaries.

Because a store big enough to buy snacks or meals is about an hour away by car, students have to rely on the meals provided by cafeteria. Of course, the cafeteria meals are provided with special care and sufficient nutrition, but a problem occurs when students miss the meal time. Since there aren't any cafes or simple restaurants to eat in, students rely on the retort or cup noodles they stack in their drawers. In other words, food supplies that depend solely on the school cafeteria aren't efficiently supplying the students' desire to intake more food.

Also, even the most basic necessities such as toothbrushes or shampoos have to be delivered by the parcel services. The lack of even a normal store makes getting such supplies not only time-consuming but also expensive. If the school were in the cities, would the students be receiving snacks or clothes by parcels?

The secluded location of the school, moreover, isolates students from the society. Even though there are text messages, phone calls and even video chats to help students keep in touch with the relations they used to prioritize before coming to the school, most relations usually end up getting weakened. Even more, because there is no TV on campus save for the one in the cafeteria, only some students are able to keep up with what's happening in the society by reading newspapers everyday. KMLA students ironically tend to be indifferent to the current issues, while they 'lighten up' their hearts by studying advanced subjects. Also because KMLA students are insensitive to the trends conveyed by the media, students tend to be unaware of prevalent jokes or names of some actors in famous dramas – most notable alienation from the society.

To many people, KMLA appears like the traditional *seowons*, the realm of study, because of the outlooks of the buildings along with its secluded location deep in the mountains. Both benefits and inconveniences that come from the isolate location exist, so it is up to the students on how the location of the school would influence the times in KMLA: heaven distant from the complicated society, or a prison alienated from the culture.

Life in the Library

Resuscitating the Heart of the Campus

Park So-Hyun
Junior Opinion Writer, 17th Wave

According to a few type-ups on Google, the College Library at Eton, a preparatory school in the United Kingdom, comprises 150,000 items, ranging in date from the 10th century to the 21st. The Weidner Library, the largest library in Harvard University, has 15.6 million volumes in a space of 350,000-square-feet.

There is a reason why the library is the pride of every major academic institution in the world. The library is a major source of learning; not only do the students learn from the facts presented in the various references, but they also learn how to search for the information they need. As the human brain has its limitations, it is imperative that all academic scholars learn how to use the resources provided effectively. Libraries are also grounds for exploration; it is the place where old interests are renewed and new interests are excavated. The size and quality of the library, therefore, is directly related to the scope of the education offered at the school.

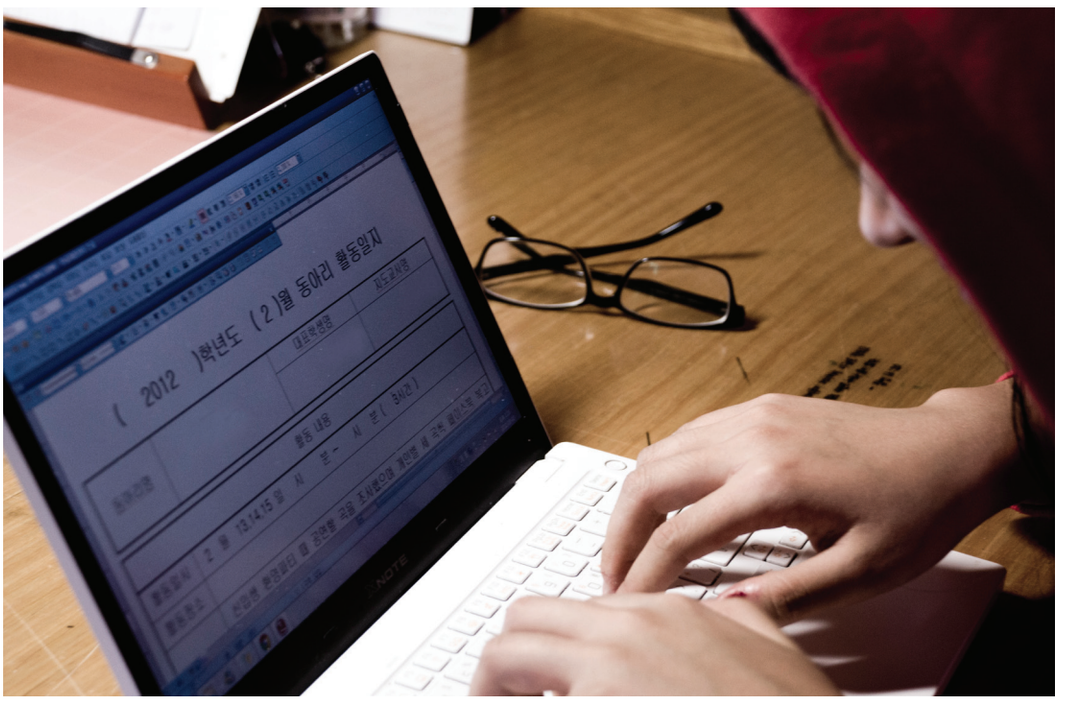
The problem with our libraries is two-fold: the first fault lies with the school and the latter with the students. On part of the school, the primary concern has to do with the amount of resources available. The most overt problem is that there is a dearth of foreign literature to be found. The status of our library of foreign books is comparable to a local library with an amateur anthology of books. One of the attractions of a library is that it enables one to explore different books that could possibly be to our taste; but with only a limited number of books-which really seem to have been garnered by some outdated list of recommended books for students-widening one's reading repertoire through library exploration is not possible.

Moreover, the library is too narrow in space to function as the 'heart' of our campus. Many complain that the computers and the printers in the library are slow and frequently break down. There should be more modern computers and printers up for use. The operation hours must also be discussed. Students find it difficult to do their research as libraries are closed during the weekend. Since the library closes precisely at five thirty, the only time that the students can really use the library is during the ten-minute break time, an inadequate amount by any standard. Students should also be allowed to use the library during the self-study period, instead of having to rely upon their laptops for research. That way, the students may get used to using library material. Additionally, they will be able to allocate their time more efficiently since research could be done during the weekend, rather than hurriedly skimmed over in ten-minute stints.

On the other hand, the students are also responsible for this problem with the library. The majority of the students choose not to take advantage of the resources that are already present in the library. The students' lack of passion in using the libraries automatically pushes the improvement of the library further back on the school's administrative agenda. Take, for instance, the operation hours. The reason why the library does not open during the weekend and at night is because, even if the library opens, students do not make an effort to use it. Apparently, the library had been open during those times in the beginning of this year, but was forced to shut down when students did not show much interest. These facts, not as well-known as the faults that the library has, tells us that students must also take it upon themselves to appreciate the library system.

In order to become the excellent school that our school seeks to be, the library must be the first to go under change. Resuscitating the libraries is essential because the only place where true active learning can take place is within open books. The effort into transformation should be reciprocal. Both sides should seek to move first. Every year, we go a step further.

Problems With Recording Club Activity Hours



One day last month, I was with my friends in the cafeteria during lunch. Soon, we started talking about club activities. One of my friends talked about how the chief of his club gave its members one activity hour for each comment on the club's online café. We all laughed, blabbering about what a silly club it was. Nevertheless, looking back, it wasn't a laughable matter at all. In Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA), where club activities have long been a popular icon of the school, such loose management over club activity hours is a serious problem.

After a bit of research, I soon realized that the problem is actually more serious and complicated than what I had expected. Intentional exaggeration as mentioned in the earlier example was thankfully scarce, but unintentional exaggeration and confusion was present in various clubs. For instance, in the Article 21, Section 6, Clause 5-E of the school law clearly states that travel time for club activity is not counted as valid club activity hours. However, *H2O*, our school's swimming club, had been constantly including the travel time to get to the swimming pool by bus in their club activity hours. Did they do it on purpose? No, even the teacher in charge of the swimming club didn't realize it was against the school law. Just what is causing all these problems?

First of all, there is the fundamental problem with the Union's limited authority. The Club Union is a student body elected every March that helps managing the club activities. It is them who compile statistics on club activity hours and hand it over to the teacher in charge which is Mr. Kwak No-Jae for this year. The thing is that there are usually only four people in this Union, two for each semester. With only two people in charge of the records of nearly 80 clubs and expecting them to discern the authenticity of the club journal is definitely too much of a burden. Thus, prosecuting exaggeration is next to impossible considering the current situation of Club Union.

Next, there is the 20-hour criterion that decides which club activity goes down in the school record. This means that if recorded club activity hour of one student for club A is over 20 hours, the fact that this student participated in club A will be written down in the school record. It appears that KMLAians in some clubs, especially small and new, exaggerate their club activity hours in order to have their activities in the club written down in their school record.

Furthermore, there is the desperate last-ditch effort of the newly created clubs to survive. School funding for club activities is so limited that to create and sustain a club requires quite a high standard. They must have continuous meetings at short intervals and come up with firm outcomes. If there is no sign of activity for a few months, Mr. Kwak would most likely disapprove of the club after its first semester. Fabricating the club activity journal that chief of each club hand in at the start of each month can bring two effects: one is that it can make their meetings look much longer and well attended with relatively short amount of time; another effect is that it can arouse member's interest in the club's activity and result in more active meetings. The club mentioned in the earlier example of the introduction was indeed a newly created club.

Most importantly, there is no written set of standards for club activity hours. How much activity hours should the chief of a newspaper club assign to its member who wrote an article? Currently, *Minjok Herald* and *Bulhwikipeunnamo* give 12-13 hours while *Math Fantasia* gives 5-6 hours. How about for participating in a competition? *English Debate Society* participates in various number of debate competitions, often lasting two days. Even for *Through the Lens*, they have their own set of system for recording club activity hours as a set time per picture uploaded. Shouldn't we have a valid rule book regarding special cases such as these?

Nevertheless, the rest of causes do have chances of improving. The cause regarding newly created clubs can be unraveled by lowering the requirements to create a club. By doing so, club members will feel less pressured to keep the club active or make it seem active from its beginning days, and the chief of the club would no longer have to ponder over fabricating club activity journal to keep the club going. Using chief's privilege to manage activity hours as part of attracting member's interest in a short period of time is most likely to be substituted by long term methods.

It is a real shame that even though years have passed since the club system was introduced to KMLA, there still exist loose holes in club policies. On the other hand, it is just another flaw that would improve KMLA still further. Let us work towards having future KMLA students better enjoy club activities in our loved school, KMLA.

Cho Seung-Hyun
Junior Opinion Writer, 17th Wave

Life Ends at 80 in KMLA

Strict Penalty Point System Raises Serious Concerns

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Life ends at 80 KMLA. Upon reaching 80 in his or her penalty points, the student is mercilessly expelled from school. While some are not intimidated and think '80 is a big number. Why should it even be a threat?' some are holding their breaths with every single penalty point newly accumulated. Although the history of the school records of only one precedent who had been expelled for penalty points, it cannot change the definitiveness with which expulsion is carried out.

At the basis of the expulsion policy is the penalty point system. KMLA puts great emphasis on the proper management of the system compared with other private boarding high schools. The consequences of high penalty points are severe: one is disqualified for receiving a scholarship, has to do manual labor, and etc.

The emphasis on the penalty point system suggests the school's ideology that a student's attitude in everyday life is as important as the student's academic achievements. Such value of the school is generally acknowledged by students. According to a brief questionnaire posted on Facebook, KMLA students responded that they did not have many complaints about penalty points, since it is compensating for what they did wrong. Also, a little effort is all that is needed to prevent excessive accumulation of penalty points. Thus, extending from these thoughts, the expulsion policy can be seen as a guide for students to have a healthy and desirable life attitude.

However, some scenes often observable in school make us frown and reconsider the justifications of the expulsion policy. On the second week of the new semester, students with high penalty points had to go through Special Training. The Special Training session resulted in empty seats in many classrooms for several days. Students wearing their casual outfits while everyone else is wearing school uniform, and carrying shovels while all else are carrying backpacks leads to a question about the adequacy of the penalty point system and the expulsion policy in an educational institution. If the '80-expulsion' is simply a guidance for students to lead diligent lives, why does it generate so much stress? Until when does the expulsion policy act as a motivation for self control, and from when does it become a threat to school life?

The main problem of the expulsion policy is that there is a lack of chances to undo the penalty points, and therefore, generates unnecessary stress. When caught for food violation or curfew violation, 5 to 10 points, or sometimes even 20 points are piled up overnight. However, to undo a single penalty point, one has to clean a classroom or an auditorium once every week, for a month. As time passes, penalty points accumulate, but they are renewed only after a year. The quick, but often steady rise in the accumulation of penalty points can be a big blow to students who get assigned for special training. Special training means manual labor instead of class. A student with 20 points needs to do special training for 2 hours, 40 points for 3 days, and 60 points for 5 days. So a student with 60 points or more cannot participate in class activities for a whole week. Is it necessary, or rather, is it justified for the school to go so far?

A better balance between promoting a healthy attitude of life and giving students freedom and the right to study is desperate. The specific methods might vary: renewing penalty accumulation every semester, broadening the chances of erasing penalty points, etc. However, all of the diverse methods must follow a single goal: they should contribute to assuaging the excessive stress on KMLA students caused by the expulsion policy.

Fading Away

How we are Losing Our KMLAian Colors

"Endowed with national pride in heart and our fatherland's bright future in mind, let us study not for the sake of personal gain but for the sake of learning itself."

"I met an admissions officer from Seoul Nantional University the other day, and what he told me was downright alarming. He said KMLA was losing its unique color; that the students no longer have the 'specialness' that used to distinguish KMLAians from other special-purpose high schools. To him, KMLA students today were desperate only for more specifications."

A shocking revelation indeed, this speech delivered by the headmaster during a recent parent meeting created quite a stir among the proud mothers and the students. For us KMLA family who pride ourselves to be the chosen few – the elites in all of Korea, such admonition from an objective outsider that we are no longer more special than other 'special'-purpose high schools is undoubtedly a decisive blow to our self-esteem.

But before we turn paranoid because a single admissions officer thought KMLA was losing it, we should first discover the virtues and values KMLA preached in the past and see if, indeed, we have been losing the 'KMLAian color.'

KMLA is founded upon the following motto: "Endowed with national pride in heart and our fatherland's bright future in mind, let us study not for the sake of personal gain but for the sake of learning itself; let us not choose a career in thoughts of personal advance but choose a career based on talents and aptitude. Such is my true happiness, tomorrow's bright fatherland, and a better world for all."

This motto clearly connotes several important virtues KMLA revered in its beginning days – it defines the KMLAian color. The warning not to be hot-eyed only about personal gain calls for self-initiation and motivation of the students when it comes to studying. It calls for the spirit of challenge and risk-taking when it states we should not choose an easy way but a way that truly fits us. The phrase that we must act on behalf of our fatherland implies that the virtue of leadership and a sense of serving the country is a prerequisite for KMLA students. Along with the distinct traditions of English Only Policy (EOP), *hanbok*, and the court system, these values worked together to raise KMLA to a prestigious school it is now. When asked what the students were like a couple of years back, a 9th waver answered without any hesitation that they were "definitely very self-motivated, independent, ambitious and hardworking" to the extent that looking back, she was "definitely really impressed at how disciplined and proactive kids were about studying, extracurricular, sports, etc. everything."

Then, are our colors fading away? Certainly, as can be seen from our lost traditions. Probably, the most representative of this is the EOP. It was kept "pretty strictly" in the past with students not being able to "get away with speaking Korean outside of [their] own rooms during school time," according to the 9th waver *sunbae*. Now, as we all know, the EOP is merely a means to show admissions officers how magnificent KMLA is during their visit.

The more frightening problem is that in the process of our traditions sliding into oblivion, it seems we are forgetting the spirit lying underneath these traditions as well. "In my view, the integrity of KMLA students is clearly fading away," says an anonymous teacher who has been teaching since the 8th wave. "What mesmerized me at first about KMLA were the students having a strong will to finish any assignments given to them, whether academic or administrative. But the students now lack that particular trait of persistence and motivation, along with the virtues of abiding the rules and the spirit of challenge. Many parents are excessively nosy about every single aspect of their child's school life so that the students are deprived of the opportunity to develop themselves into a responsible, autonomous being. Instead of cultivating the responsibility that is expected from a future leader, students settle for what they have now and seek a safe future." A biting commentary from an old teacher who has observed students for nearly a decade, this surely proves that the admission's officer's remark was not presumptuous at all.

The bleaching of the KMLAian color is not a one-dimension-type matter to be simply resolved by investing more money or implementing more policies. It calls for a fundamental reconstruction of the KMLAian mind right now when KMLA is entering an epoch abounding with problems to be solved and improvements to be made. But before we deal with all the trifling troubles concerning some hardware breakdowns or minor aspects of school bureaucracy, the most urgent quest for KMLA is a renaissance of old KMLA, a repainting of the KMLA spirit with its unique, traditional color. Let us anticipate and work towards a reinvigoration of our old spirit, the spirit when the students had to build up the reputation of the school by themselves, unlike today where the students take such reputation for granted.

Where the Sidewalk Ends

from the book “Where the Sidewalk Ends” (1974)

There is a place where the sidewalk ends
and before the street begins,
and there the grass grows soft and white,
and there the sun burns crimson bright,
and there the moon-bird rests from his flight
to cool in the peppermint wind.

Let us leave this place where the smoke blows black
and the dark street winds and bends.
Past the pits where the asphalt flowers grow
we shall walk with a walk that is measured and slow
and watch where the chalk-white arrows go
to the place where the sidewalk ends.

Yes we’ll walk with a walk that is measured and slow,
and we’ll go where the chalk-white arrows go,
for the children, they mark, and the children, they know,
the place where the sidewalk ends.